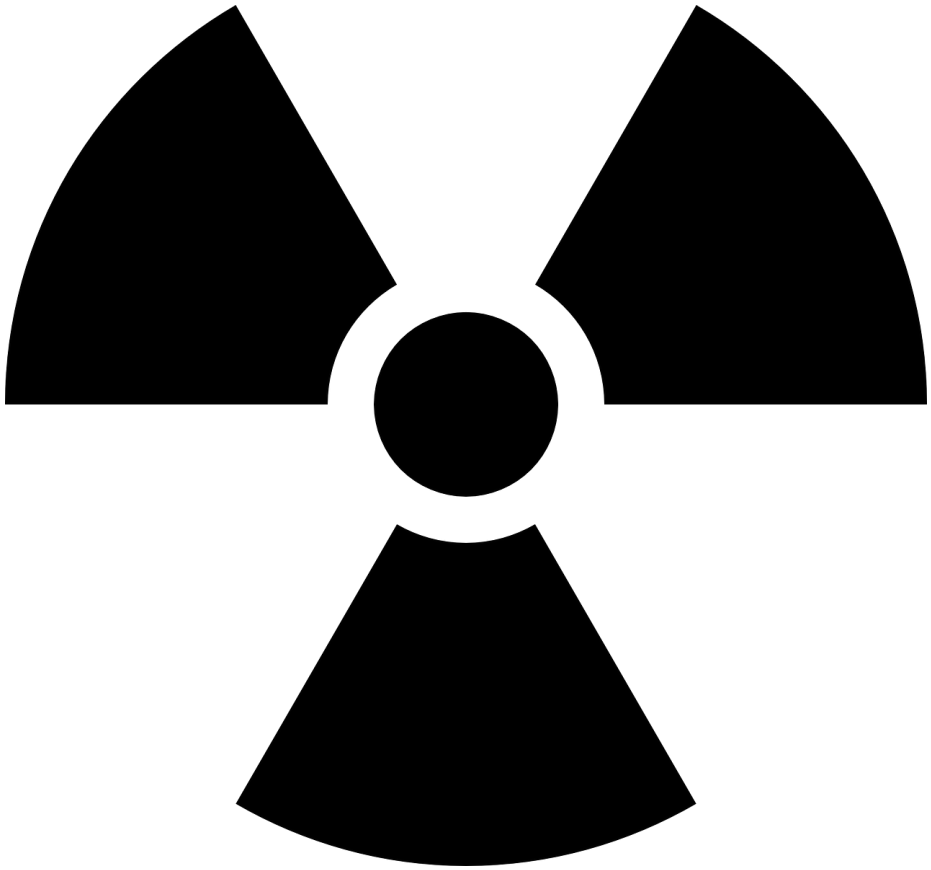
501 RADS

or, the radioman's guide to the wasteland



Introduction:

Hello new wastelander! Welcome to the most comprehensive guide to surviving and thriving in the nuclear wasteland that has become of earth! My name is Wacky Jack, and I am the author of this guide! I hope the information within will lead you to many safe adventures. Without further ado, let us break down the past, present, and future of this fine world!

The history of our fine earth:

The irradiated hellscape you see around you today is the result of some very poor choices made by our forebearers. In order to understand the current situation of the wasteland, we must first understand its origin! The best place to start must surely be the year of our lord 1945, when “Little Boy” and “Fat Man” took the lives

of 200,000 people. Since then, generals and politicians alike just could not quit sending nuclear bombs to places they don't belong! Not long after, in the year 1968 another unfortunate nuclear incident occurred in Vietnam. Not long after what would be known as the "My Lai Massacre", where American soldiers massacred a Vietnamese village, a Vietnamese spy and former victim of MK Ultra would smuggle a nuclear weapon into Saigon and end the Vietnam War early. This nuclear detonation broke a 23 year span of nuclear peace, a peace which sadly would never be found again. America immediately blamed the Soviet Union for the detonation, leading to the then most tense moment of the Cold War. Though the world did not end that day, many agree that the destruction of Saigon set off a chain of events that would lead to the world you see today.

That would not be all that happened. Not long after in 1972 the terrorist faction Black September would take Israeli hostages at the

Munich Olympics, leading to multiple deaths and an increase in hostilities in the middle east. Shortly after, an Israeli spy was arrested in Cairo, seemingly with the intention to assassinate the leader of Egypt, Anwar Sadat. With this crucial arrest, there were no hopes of de-escalating the tensions in the middle east. Tensions in the region would grow, and by 1978 a war would break out, with western powers fighting to defend Israel against its Arab neighbors. The Soviet Union saw an opportunity to weaken western morale and hegemony, and funded and supplied Arab nations in their assault, leading to a sustained war in the late 70's and 80's known as the First Sinai War. Some eastern Arab states would eventually join the Soviet Union, including Afghanistan and much later, Iran. The first Sinai War only ended in 1986 when the Chernobyl Disaster greatly weakened the Soviet Union. Despite the best efforts of the USSR, a great amount of radiation entered the groundwater and later the Pripyat River, which eventually feeds into the Dnieper. This led to a

Europe spanning health crisis where an estimated 20 Million died, from both Soviet Bloc and Western Nations. It was at this time that the Soviet Union committed extensive resources to developing secret weapons and treatment in the Chernobyl zone, making attempts to both immunize their people against the dangers of radiation, and to use it more effectively as a weapon against their enemies. The great crisis that killed so many would come to be known as the “Green Death”. This event would lead to considerable rises in European Anti-Soviet sentiment, leading to a Ukrainian politician assassinating Gorbachev during a press meeting. Though many were glad to hear of the death of the Soviet leader, his replacement was far worse. Boris Lyapunov took office in 1987 and would lead the USSR for many years. Lyapunov sought to relight nationalist pride in the USSR and strengthen its morale, and so Lyapunov arranged the third and final nuclear exchange of the pre-apocalyptic globe. Via propaganda and targeted assassinations, the KGB raised tensions

in the Middle East once again, inciting a nuclear exchange between India and Pakistan, as well as an Iranian nuclear bombing of Tel Aviv. While this surely seemed to be the beginning of the end, Lyapunov did not wish to end the world, he merely wished to distract the globe while his nation regained its power. The United States did not strike first, and so neither did the USSR. The death toll from the exchange in southern Asia was immense, and the ensuing Indo-Pakistan War would all but wipe out both sides. Meanwhile, the Second Sinai War began, with a retaliatory invasion of Egypt, Iraq, and Iran by NATO forces. While many suspected it, it was not yet confirmed that the USSR was behind the bombing, so all effort was focused on seizing Tehran and any more nuclear weapons held there.

Meanwhile, the USSR regained its strength, and though some estimates said it may fall by 1991, the nation reached a new peak, both in technological prowess and nationalistic pride. Lyapunov's investment paid off, and he was able

to sell weapons to the Iranians who had become more wealthy under Soviet control, earning needed money for the mainland and draining the already weakened west of its resources. By 1994 Tehran was taken, but this was of no concern to the USSR. They had successfully recovered from the 1986 Chernobyl disaster and reached a new peak of prowess. Around this time the Chinese were coming to power as well, seeking to rival their neighbor Russia as a great Communist state. Despite their shared ideology, the two nations held some hatred for one another. China began to brutally conquer and annex much of Asia during the Indo-Pakistan war, as its only major regional competitor, India, was decimated by the conflict. First, China annexed the Koreas, and despite their pleas, American intervention in the Koreas never came. Japan followed soon after, and though they put up a fight, overwhelming Chinese numbers overcame the island nation. Not long after, the Chinese swept through the rest of Asia and controlled everything from Jakarta to Beijing. India and

Pakistan would continue to fight to the last man, and when the dust had settled China would claim what little shred of civilization was left there.

The year is now 1995, and The USSR and CCP have reached new heights of global dominance as the west reels from war. The United States, feeling the pressure placed upon them by the eastern nations, begins to expand in turn. The USA would first annex Mexico, who willingly became part of the USA. The USA began a rapid and brutal criminal cleansing of Mexico, oftentimes resulting in huge collateral losses, rapidly losing the trust of the Mexican people. Shortly after, in 1996, the USA would invade Canada, and in three months would force the nation to be subject to American rule. In September of that year the Quebec Massacre saw the deaths of 130 protestors after an experimental crowd control weapon, one of the early Laser weapons, caused much more harm than intended. The USA was now struggling to maintain its control over the two

nations it had recently taken over, and the globe had reached levels of tension never seen before. Around this time, western Europe saw a second catastrophe when the Civaux Nuclear Power Plant had a massive failure, resulting in what many called a "Second Chernobyl". Civaux was positioned near much of France's fertile farmland, and so a great famine accompanied the disaster, leading to even more death in western Europe. With the West occupied, USA struggling for control, and the East expanding, the final steps towards destruction would commence. In 2001, Saudi Arabian terrorists would fly planes into the World Trade Center, claiming revenge for the destruction wrought during the Sinai Wars, namely the accidental bombing of a refugee camp. For the third time in a century, American troops were sent to the middle east to find and destroy the terrorists, but this time with no help from any other nation. This campaign was a disaster, only increasing the divide between eastern and western power. Around this time, the American government was hurting badly for money,

and a number of enterprising businesses fought for government contracts. The government became increasingly reliant on its new corporate backbone, and by 2008 was beginning to lose any hope of recovering. Three major corporations would rise to become household names. DynamoCo, Rothberg, and Nutrocorp. DynamoCo capitalized on new breakthroughs in Nuclear and Laser technology to become the forefront of energy and technology, and their lack of government regulation led to their products being both very fast to develop and rarely safe. Rothberg emerged at the top of the financial food chain, and would rapidly become the holder of almost all wealth in the nation, working closely with the other two corporate giants to maintain domination. Nutrocorp seized all the food and water production of the nation and became the arbiters of nutrition, pumping out inexpensive and unhealthy food en masse. These three corporations would steer the nation through the trying times of the 21st century.

In 2011, Canadian terrorists bombed the Statue of Liberty, leading to an even more oppressive regime being installed in Canada, attempting to beat the rebellion out of them. All the while the Eastern Nations now thrived, seeming more and more undefeatable. This unbridled progress in the east was riding on top of a terrible truth: the world was running out of oil. Part of how the east and west alike were able to grow despite the turmoil of the world was oil, and it was starting to run dry. Russia would begin to feel the scarcity first, as oil fields across the USSR began to run dry. Not long after, the USA's oil, supplied partly by its involvement in the middle east and by the Gulf of Mexico, also began to run dry. Following suit, China too began to see its oil start to vanish. For those high ups in the world it was clear to see that something would break soon. The world had survived three nuclear engagements, but only barely. What would happen once the lifeblood of the world stopped flowing? Nations raced to develop alternative solutions, but the more they

tried, the more oil seemed like the solution. If only each nation could have all the world's oil to themselves…

In 2017 a breakthrough in nuclear power would come in a Chinese lab, when scientists developed a stable, self contained, small sized nuclear energy cell, capable of powering a neighborhood for a year. Spies from the other two nations were rampant in China, as was the case for every nation in the world, and so shortly thereafter the USA and USSR would develop their own prototypes. The miracle technology seemed like it would save the world, but before long the world governments also realized its use in warfare. With these, armies could wage large scale war, but potentially avoid a nuclear exchange. If this didn't solve the oil crisis directly, then perhaps it could instead solve it indirectly. All three nations developed weapons of war, rather than using the technology to solve the energy problems. In the USSR, the nationalist rhetoric was that war was

inevitable, and that the USSR must be strong and ready. In China, the sentiment was much the same. The Chinese were furious that their breakthrough, their chance at an upper hand was stolen, and so they built weapons of their own. The USA, steered by DynamoCo's violent ambitions, developed weapons too, and the final nail in the coffin was hammered in. In 2021, World War Three officially began. China and the USSR immediately began fighting on their shared border, the new laser weaponry being used to terrifying effect. In 2022, a small, localized nuclear weapon was developed and deployed onto battlefields, acting as a bridge between conventional and nuclear explosives. China invaded Alaska not long after the start of the war, as Alaska was the sole remaining source of American Oil. Meanwhile in Europe the last bastions of western power fell as the USSR fought to take the whole continent.

In 2025, all hell broke loose. The USA realized that they had fallen behind. During the late 90s

and 2000s, they had finally failed to keep pace with the east. The Rothberg banks were beginning to run low on money, and the nation had to ration electricity in order to save what little energy they had left. In China, an internal Capitalist rebellion against the harsh rule of the CCP led to governmental instability, and in the USSR the assasination of Boris Lyapunov caused a collapse of the power structure. To this day it is unknown who launched the first strike, but on Christmas Eve, 2026, the world underwent a full nuclear exchange. Moscow, Beijing, and DC were decimated, just like every other site of importance anywhere on earth. And just like that, the world as we knew it ended. Today, Christmas is not much of a holiday, and everyone refers to that day as “Christmas Eve”.

The USA, Today!

Fuck all that gloomy bullshit though! The one good thing that came of all this is true

American freedom, like the founding fathers intended! You don't care about any of that boring history, you care about right here and right now! So, let's talk about the fine folks and weird radioactive quirks that shape our world today!

The Radiomen

Considering you are reading this fine guide then I suppose you have heard of my guild, the Radiomen. We are a collection of sensible folk who communicate over a network of nationwide radio antennae, which is partly how I have amassed so much knowledge! Radiomen across the wasteland are committed to bringing some common sense to the world, by any means possible. We radiomen like to broadcast any news we can, giving reports on local events, playing music, or chatting with other radiomen. Unlike many other factions, we are a rather loose knit bunch, but fiercely loyal nonetheless. If you are

ever in danger, find a radio and maybe there will be a radioman on the other end to help you out! We radiomen have developed a number of secret communication tricks to stay in the know with one another. Most importantly, we always sign off with “Over” or “Over and Out.” While it may seem corny, it helps us know when we are talking to a true radioman, or some devilish imposter. Additionally, we use the word “indubitably” to indicate that whatever we are about to say is the opposite of the truth, and some other neat tricks I’ll have to teach you sometime. I can’t put them all in here or my secrets are toast!

Raiders and their offshoots...

The greatest scum in the wasteland are the raiders. These are the antithesis of the Radiomen. Raiders are a catchall term for the many disparate groups of roving murderers who

prey upon the good men and women of our fine nation. Raiders in general use brutality and scare tactics to bully people into submission, but are more often than not poorly organized, cowardly, and easy to avoid or scare off. This is not true of some of the larger and more organized raider bands, detailed below.

The MP (military police)

The MP are a large and well organized raider band consisting of many, you guessed it, former military personnel. While many American soldiers died in the events surrounding Christmas Eve, either directly in the war or in the aftermath, some remained. Some of the more violent and opportunistic veterans would form their own raider band, which they call the Military Police. Their own internal rhetoric preaches that the only way to bring order to the wasteland is through extreme violence, which the faction seems to revere as gospel. The faction is known for its pseudo-militaristic regime, with ‘ranks’ and a coherent power structure. The

MP is largely decentralized today, with no true leader or central leadership. Rather, individual chapters will have a General, who serves as a regional leader. Generally, chapters of the MP do not interact much, but when they do they have been known to cooperate. In regions with a large MP presence, the group has been known to enforce protection tax, tolls on well traveled roads, and carry out executions and other mob justice. They are also known to have underlying attachments to pre-war white supremacist racist groups, such as The Base. The modern MP hates mutants of all varieties, and more extreme chapters are known to execute anyone with visible mutation on sight.

Junkie Crews

Another vile subsection of the greater raider issue is the Junkie Crews, a loose term for groups of raiders with a specific drive to fuel crippling addictions. The Nutrocorp regime of the late pre-war era had set up a

pharmacological empire based upon addicting civilians to drugs. Unlike some of the more obviously harmful drugs of the late 20th century, Nutrocorp took immense care to brand their products as healthy and useful, and also to ensure their products have few to no visible side effects. This insidious model of business left a generation addicted to drugs they didn't even know they were addicted to. People in the post-war era have more or less figured out that these drugs are harmful, but for many it is too late. Junkie Crews will murder for their drugs, and with Nutrocorp no longer mass producing the drugs, they take to manufacturing their own. Nutrocorp is known to hire, enslave, or train people to cook and manufacture their drugs for them, and some particular organizations have even taken over and restored functionality to medical centers or pharma production centers. They do not do this out of the kindness of their heart, and have been known to play the same game as Nutrocorp, getting wastelanders addicted to their product. These operations have also been

known to operate side hustles, including farming human beings and even babies for organs.

For more details on the many drugs fueling the wasteland, see the dedicated section for drugs.

Tech Cults

Some raiders have attempted to gain supremacy in the form of technological advancement. Noble, no? Tech Cults take on two major forms, the religious and non-religious. The former consists of those who, to varying extents, lack understanding of their technology to a great enough extent to worship it. Many of these groups are headed by charismatic leaders who know full well that there is no god behind the machine, but spreading the idea to their supporters brings them immense power. Many of the cultists of this variety of tech cult were born post-war, and know no better about what they are seeing. The non-religious cults are no better, as they murder and pillage all the same,

technology serving as a stand in for true courage or power.

Tech Cults love military sites, as they often contain the cutting edge tech they seek. Tech cults have been known to train trusted members in surprisingly advanced tech skills, and some are incredible hackers.

The Sea-Raiders

There is a group of raiders on the east coast of America famous for their large Flotilla cities and their affinity for murdering and robbing people up and down the east coast. They are most prominent in the Northeast, and will use the waterways of the coast, as well as the ocean, to travel a large area of the nation, stealing from as many people as they can. They are rumored to have a capital city floating out in the ocean somewhere. They embrace traditional pirate stereotypes, and like to fancy themselves as post nuclear swashbucklers.

The Dosers

The Dosers are without a doubt the most insane of the raider clans. The Dosers have literally become addicted to radiation. The majority of Dosers were regular raiders who survived encounters with extreme radiation and were exiled from their former community. These groups are full of the most horrifically mutated humans who still draw breath, and Dosers have developed a sort of Stockholm Syndrome, where many of them will regularly expose themselves to extreme rads to try to bring about benign mutation. Many of them die very shortly after becoming inducted into the group.

Dosers are also known to kidnap normal people, which they derogatorily refer to as “smoothskins” or “the unenlightened”, and force them to absorb high amounts of radiation. The dosers see this as an act of kindness, as they will either die and be freed from this world, or

ascend to a level of divine mutation. Dosers are to be avoided at all costs, for those who wish to stay sane (or alive).

Caravaners/Nomads

While most raider bands like to choose a small region to try to dominate, other packs operate like nomads, wandering around and pillaging regions in a quick strike before disappearing from the area. To the nomads, this has benefits, as they never stick around long enough to be hunted down.

The Caravaners are a well organized nomad clan who are known to transport and traffic goods for anyone with money. They are as reliable as you pay them to be, and are known to reliably deliver for individuals who pay upfront and often. They are still brutal, but unlike many other factions, they at least provide a scrap of value to the rest of us. Caravaners are both respected, feared, and targeted for their cargo

carrying abilities. If you want to ambush and rob a group of Caravaners, you best not miss.

Other militant groups

In addition to the many raider groups, some less useless groups exist. While these groups are still violent and dangerous, some of them are respectable and don't prey on innocents.

The Patriots

The patriots are the noble counterpart of the MP, and preach many of the same ideals, but with far less of the private executions. The patriots are also comprised of many ex-military types, but are generally less interested in domination and more interested in keeping everyone alive. While corruption within The Patriots is not unheard of, the group is largely respected by most and is known to defend major settlements in exchange for the respect and support of the

locals. Also unlike the MP, the Patriots are a centralized group, and are known to send reinforcements to areas that request assistance. Like their name suggests, the Patriots are headquartered in Massachusetts, and use Gillette Stadium, the home of the New England Patriots, as their base of operations. The Patriots frequently use Radiomen to transmit messages across our secure channels, which we do happily.

The Domain of Iron (DOI)

The DOI is a post-American military group with mixed reviews. The DOI is incredibly well equipped, and their blurry past raises many suspicions about their origin. The group seems to be headquartered at a series of Oil Rigs in the Gulf of Mexico, and operates a small fleet of naval vessels in those waters. They also control a large amount of land and air vehicles, which generally make up the bulk of their power and strategy. The DOI seem to be few in number, but still powerful via their equipment. They have

been known to exhibit supremacist ideals, using enigmatic and specific exams to determine a human's "Use Factor", a statistic that was popular under the Rothberg corporate template in the pre-war era to determine the inherent usefulness of a person. In the pre-war era, a high UF could earn you better positions in life, though many of the day claimed the statistic was largely made up and was fabricated by those at the top to maintain power. The DOI now uses this in their own modified way to divide people into three categories. The highest bracket is those who they see fit to join their ranks, which they will often recruit. Below that, is the average man, who is nothing special but still acceptable to them. These people are never permitted to join or serve in any capacity, but will be allowed to go about their day. The lowest bracket is the 'nonhuman', who are best fit for slavery or death. Because of this system, many hate the DOI (reasonably so), but they have been known to come to the aid of innocents on many occasions. Rumors have it that after defeating

some group (often raiders), the surviving enemy force is forced to take their exams, and any who score high enough are recruited anyways. If this is to be believed, then many DOI soldiers may well be former raiders.

The formation of the DOI is murky, and many have theorized that the DOI might predate the war, and were perhaps formed before the war to provide a sort of new power to the elites of the military and corporations to seize new power in the post-war era once the inevitability of nuclear war became apparent to the elite class. These theories would explain the large resource pool and seemingly serendipitous territory the DOI controls. Their loyalties are to themselves and themselves only, so try to stay out of their way.

The DOI is known to operate mostly in the American south.

The Cybernet

A mysterious organization (which may or may not even be real) known as the Cybernet is said to operate nationwide. The group reportedly lives in underground labs, and kidnaps and replaces people with robotic replicas, and then spies on people through the robots.

Little is known about them, and any talk of them is in whispered rumors. If they are even real, they are very secretive.

Firewatch / Ski Patrol

Firewatch, and its sister faction Ski Patrol both operate in the mountainous regions of the United States. Firewatch operates largely in Appalachia, and Ski Patrol largely in the Rocky Mountains. Since the devastation brought on by the war caused a nuclear winter, the whole world got a lot colder, including the mountains. As such, the Appalachians and Rockies are snow

covered year round. The environment in these places is very rough, and so few live there. Those who do have the benefit of being relatively safe from raiders, as the raiders cannot sustain anything there, but suffer from the general inhospitality of the region. Firewatch and Ski Patrol have no formal connection but operate very similarly. Both provide protection and organization to the communities of the mountainous regions. If you can survive and make it to these communities, and go there with good intentions, these mountain settlements can be a safe haven.

The Cartel

The cartel is a shady group that operates out of Southern Florida, specifically what remains of Miami. After the annexation of Mexico and the Caribbean, many Cubans and Mexicans moved to Miami and the already Hispanic influenced south of Florida. Post-war, this community coalesced into ‘The Cartel’ which is to some extent a

misnomer. The group does produce drugs, but unlike the cartels of the past is relatively nonviolent, and mostly produces useful drugs like radiation medication and similar.

The Cartel owns lots of valuable property, and is fiercely territorial over it. While the Cartel Communities get along well with each other, they are hostile to outsiders for the most part.

Voodoo Mafia

The Voodoo Mafia is a gang somewhere between raiders and vigilantes. The group operates out of the Bayou country in and around Louisiana, and is known to hunt down Raiders and all the other crazy horseshit that goes down in the Bayou. They are also known to conduct crazy rituals involving human sacrifice and have been accused of just about anything reprehensible you can imagine. The group is famously hard to join or even find for that matter, as they value a sense of secrecy and surprise. They clearly are quite powerful, as their control over the Bayou

recently led to the major routes through the region becoming safe again, but no one fully understands how. More information about the Bayou can be found in its own section later.

The Harlem Communities

The Harlem Communities are groups of surviving New Yorkers who converted the gang culture of pre-war New York into a post-war community of tenuous stability. The community lives in the decimated ruins of the Big Apple, and maintains much of the culture it had before the war. There are gangs, such as the Bloods and Crips, who fight over everything, just like they used to. Only now, there is no law enforcement, and the city is in shambles. New York is a hell hole, and these folk are somehow the most civil people there. When they aren't actively in a turf war, these people are quite nice and tight knit within their own gangs.

The Monumentals

In the ruins of Washington DC live a very strange and violent group of cultists called the Monumentals. Though few survive encounters with them, reports indicate that the Monumentals in some way ‘worship’ the Washington Monument, claiming that it is a source of great power and deserves great respect. Suspicions around why the Monumentals act the way they do are unclear. Some theorize that they are another example of a charismatic leader abusing a large group of people. Others believe in a pre-war conspiracy theory that says that a government project under MK-Ultra installed mind control tech inside the Washington Monument and other notable buildings or monuments around the country to experiment on the masses with. Neither idea sounds very realistic.

The Monumentals are very well equipped, well organized, and seem to be universally enthralled by the Monument and its promises. Steer clear of

this faction at all costs, as they are typically hostile on sight.

The Evolved

In the final days of World War 3 the USSR developed a bio-weapon called Radiovirus Omicron, commonly called RVO. RVO is a highly modified version of the common cold produced by developing a virus that is very resistant to radiation, and then irradiating the virus. The virus then infects a host, and as well as causing normal cold symptoms, exposes the infected person's DNA to the radioactive viral DNA. In most cases, this kills the victim, but in some rare cases the modified RNA of the virus, combined with the radioactivity, can lead to a rapid 'evolution' of the infected. Radioactive RNA and DNA from the virus replace the host's, resulting in a strange twisting of the human form. Survivors of RVO are called 'The Evolved', as they have taken on some extreme changes to their biology as a result of the RVO. Further

examples of the common types of Evolved can be found in their own section later on. The evolved are often outcast from society, and develop a supremacist identity, thinking themselves a better, stronger version of humanity. They form insular communities where they kidnap humans to use as slaves, or as food.

Wireminds

Wireminds are independent, autonomous, sometimes sentient helper robots that have since gone rogue due to radiation disrupting their central processing. They roam in packs, have a general hatred for their human overlords, take human slaves, and are very resistant to damage. In a few communities, Wireminds have learned to create new generations of robots using factories. In other places, they are unable to reproduce, and thus are insular and avoid conflict.

Governmental Organizations

Many regions have had governments or something similar attempt to resettle and revive communities across America. Below is a list of both successful and unsuccessful attempts at forming local governments.

The Olympic Commonwealth

In the pacific northwest, communities from Oregon and Washington have formed a strong and safe community, free from many of the issues of the rest of the country. The region is cold and wet, and isn't completely free from raiders, but is generally well policed, and has recently begun collecting tax, holding elections, and started forging the path back to sane civilization. Seattle was leveled in the war, so Portland is the capital of the region. As far as we know,

there is no place on earth more civilized than The OC today.

The OC is experiencing some growing pains, however, and the bigger the communities get, the more effort will need to be put to maintain order. If there is any hope for America, it lies in the OC.

The State of Jefferson

Literal days after the bombs fell, groups of right wing Californians from the north of California saw their opportunity to create the state they had long desired. Since the 1940s Californians had wanted to form a state in the north of California, which they would call Jefferson. They formed it, and it lasted a whole 3 years before internal struggle and external pressure collapsed the loose confederation of communities. That region is now home to a number of raiders, small redneck gangs, and all manner of horseshit.

The Los Angeles Republic

In the former city of Los Angeles and the surrounding region of southern California and parts of Nevada lies the shattered and fragmented Los Angeles Republic. Founded in 2029, the LAR sought to establish a new civilization in the American southwest. By some standards, the LAR is the most successful settlement of all time, but cracks threaten to doom the republic.

The LAR has, much like the United States before it, adopted a two party system. The official titles of the two parties are unimportant, as everyone today knows them as the California Party and the Nevada Party. The California Party has long been the dominant party, but in recent years the Nevada Party has gained notoriety for its promises of a better LAR. The biggest fronts of debate between the parties are the issues of mutants, dealing with raiders, and tax. The

California Party has been criticized for its lack of strong policy, with many thinking that the Party is too relaxed on crime, too welcoming of dangerous peoples, and does not enforce enough law over its people. This has led to the Nevada Party forming a populist identity, promising the expulsion of mutants, and the cleansing of the territory of crime. Opponents of the Nevada Party warn that the authoritarian suggestions compromise the founding principles of the LAR and that if the Nevada Party comes to power the LAR will transition to an authoritarian police state. In any case, the LAR is struggling, as years of indecision and infighting have allowed opportunistic raider bands to reap and pillage the relatively rich land. Furthermore, allegations of corruption have been levied at LAR Prime Minister Jose Manchado, some even claiming he is being paid by raider gangs to turn a blind eye to their violence.

The fate of the LAR hangs in the balance. With level heads and wise choices, the nation could become a great new civilization in the wasteland. With poor direction, it may be a forgotten footnote in the next few years.

The New South

The New South isn't actually a government, but rather a style of living common in the American south. The New South has adopted a very wild western ideology, where people are generally expected to take care of themselves. Southerners will generally be weary of outsiders or unusual folk, but are quick to come to the aid of other reputable southerners. The New South has no government or true laws, but communities have been known to put together and fund local private law enforcement, often referring to them as sheriffs or rangers. The job of a New South is dangerous and risky, but carries respect and honor. In some ways, the sheriffs are 'lawful raiders', as much of their livelihood relies on

killing raiders and looting them. The only difference is that the sheriffs protect the innocent (or so they should).

The largest of the New South communities have small governments or city councils that rarely actually do anything. Dallas, New Orleans, Atlanta, and Houston are the best examples, as they all have somewhat substantial communities that rely on the understated promise of violence if anyone breaks the perceived law.

The Mountain Towns

As previously detailed, the mountainous regions of the United States are home to a few major settlements that have chosen nature as their enemy instead of raiders. These towns often have city councils of elected leaders, a mayor, and a sheriff. The mountains of the United States are incredibly harsh; the nuclear war made the world's climate far more extreme. The mountains experience harsh blizzards year round, as well

as the same dreaded radstorms the rest of the world faces. Due to the relatively low number of high priority targets in the mountains of America, few nuclear weapons detonated in the mountains. There are two notable exceptions to this, those being the Cheyenne Mountain complex in Colorado Springs, and the Langston Targeting Array near Summersville, West Virginia. These sites were both crucial in the American nuclear program, and received heavy amounts of nuclear bombardment. Other than these sites, the mountains are relatively low in radiation. There are still a number of highly dangerous mutant animals that live in the area, such as the exceptionally dangerous radbears of the rocky mountains, and the wendigo of the Appalachians. These communities are rugged survivalists who rely heavily on well maintained, climate controlled greenhouses. Most labor of the community is centered around ensuring that the farming equipment is not damaged, as growing crops in the harsh snow is impossible without the right tools.

The Toronto Raptors

The Toronto Raptors have a long and storied history. Originally, they were a professional basketball (an old American sport akin to polehole) team. When America annexed Canada, they made an effort to destroy all Canadian icons or culture in an attempt to assimilate the Canadian identity into America, and this included the breakdown of their sports teams. Later, a group of Canadian terrorists would begin calling themselves the Raptors, both as an homage to their old sports team, and as a symbol of power and culture. This group would go on to bomb the Statue of Liberty, making a statement about the destruction of liberty in America. When the bombs fell, the organization shifted into a Canadian nationalist group, based out of both Toronto and Quebec. The group is staunchly anti-American, promotes the learning of French instead of English as a language, and is now the primary government in southern Canada. Little

more about them is known by us Radiomen, as they are insular and refuse to speak to Americans.

Creatures, Criminals, and Commoners:

The below section is a detailed compendium of the myriad different people you might meet and enemies you may face!

Humans

Humans come in two varieties: good guy and bad guy. Here is a few examples of how to spot the difference:

Rule 1:
Good guys and bad guys alike carry weapons. Just because someone has a weapon, does not mean they are dangerous.

Rule 2:
Good guys rarely carry the trophies of dead victims on their person. If the person you are speaking to has human bones, teeth, skulls, etc. on their person, they are probably a bad guy.

Rule 3:
Bad guys are often addicted to drugs. Look for the tell tale signs, like yellowed teeth, skin, and eyes, as well as collapsed veins in the arms.

Rule 4:
Bad guys will frequently use hostages, slaves, and other forms of human suffering to their advantage. Look out for this!

Rule 5:
Trust your gut. Better that some random dies than you!

With these out of the way, we can talk about some common bad guy archetypes

The Raider Capitan

Raider captains, as the name suggests, are the leaders of a group of raiders. More often than not they have some unique skill that elevates them to the position of captain, that skill most often being violence. Usually, killing the captain of a raider crew will temporarily scatter them, at least until a new captain makes himself known.

The MP Sergeant

An MP sergeant, much like the raider captain, is a specialized MP raider who controls a 'battalion' of MP raiders. He is often a self-indulgent military cosplayer with delusions of grandeur and a god complex. They can often be seen barking orders at their soldiers.

The Dealer

Junkie crews will often have one or multiple 'dealers', leaders who control the supply and

flow of drugs in the community. In some junkie crews, the dealers are basically worshipped as gods for their ability to supply drugs. Junkie crews are very protective of their dealers, and dealers take extensive measures to keep their recipes and stashes secret so as to not be replaceable. Control over a dealer is control over a large amount of junkies. Some dealers avoid using the drugs they control, others don't.

The Tech Priest

The Tech Cults of the wasteland are always led by their Tech Priest. The non-religious tech cults are typically led by the person with the most technical knowledge about technology, which often makes them very dangerous people to mess with. The more religious tech cults are more often led by the most charismatic member of the cult, as opposed to the smartest or strongest. In either case, the tech cult looks to them for direction.

The Mailman

The Caravaners often have one or multiple organizers who are known by many as the mailman of that group. They are often not one of the deliverers, but rather are in charge of taking contracts from people and organizing the movement of goods. Mailmen are often hard to buy or bribe, but have on some occasions been known to double cross clients. They rarely tell anyone their real name, and often go by pseudonyms. Mailmen might live in the wasteland as a hermit, or might live in a settlement in secret. They are hard to track down, but can be valuable allies.

The Decoy

A famous and favorite tactic among criminals and raiders is the trusty decoy. The decoy, sometimes a raider in disguise and other times a slave or hostage, is placed in a public location to beg for help or act injured. If any kind souls happen by, the decoy lures them into vulnerability and then the nearby raiders ambush

the kind soul. Always be suspicious of “hurt” people who are completely alone in the middle of nowhere.

Creatures

Creatures, unlike humans, have no rules. They are cruel survivalists. Since the bombs fell, almost all wildlife that didn't evolve died off, so expect to see lots of freaks and other crazy stuff.

Danger Level 1

Below is a list of Danger Level 1 creatures documented in my database that might help you survive. This list doesn't contain every animal, just the useful or interesting ones. Feel free to radio me if you think anything needs to be added to the list!

- Rad Rabbits

    - Cute, Fluffy, Non-hostile. Smell like burnt skin. Their organs can be used to brew anti-rad concoctions
- Green Salamanders
    - Not to be confused with red salamanders, or the salamanders group of mercenaries
    - Glow bright green in the presence of radiation
- Three Eye Possums
    - Three eye possums have developed a third eye, and the ability to use all three eyes independently, like a chameleon
    - Like to steal valuables and hoard them in dens. Finding a possum den can lead to treasure
    - Hard to sneak up on or catch.
- Skulldeer
    - Skulldeer are a terrifying deer species who grow no skin. They look decayed and dead at all times, but due to having no skin have become very disease resistant.
    - Their liver can be used to make disease cures

- Ferrobeaver
    - Ferrobeaver are a beaver species who developed iron teeth and bones as a result of a genetic mutation
    - They gnaw on rubble and ruins to get iron to make dams. The dams made of iron are less effective at blocking streams.
    - Ferrobeavers make great pets, and can destroy robots effectively by chewing them apart.
- Radcoon
    - Not to be confused with the slur used by New Southerners for dosers.
    - Radcoons are irradiated raccoons, and the sworn rivals of three eyed possums. Radcoons can handle radioactive material without issue, and seem to heal wounds when in the presence of rads.
    - They can be followed to sources of radiation, or trained to steal radioactive materials.
- Armordillo

    - Armordillos are a modified species of armadillo which have developed hard calcium carbonate shells which are very heat and damage resistant
    - If hunted, the shells can be made to make fireproof armor
- Radpie
    - Radpie are a species of magpie which have developed near-perfect and very loud imitation skills. By playing sounds for them, you can train them to make the sound.

Danger Level 2

Here is a list of danger level 2 creatures. These are creatures which can pose a serious threat to humans, but which have known weaknesses.

- Snake Coyotes
    - Snake Coyotes are an evolved species of coyote which are also venomous and have long fangs. Their venom can be extracted

    to create antivenom, or a potent toxin for offensive uses.
- Coyote Snakes
    - Coyote Snakes are an evolved rattlesnake species which has learned to hunt in packs and has a sort of short range hivemind
    - Have been known to combine into a single large team snake
- Murder Turkey
    - The Murder Turkey is an evolved, aggressive turkey which attacks anything it sees unprovoked
    - It has developed flight without needing to climb to a high place, and has learned to use its weight as a weapon
    - Apparently it's still delicious. A delicacy even.
- Tusker
    - Tuskers are incredibly big wild hogs. Almost elephant size, they are a huge threat close up, but are incredibly slow

    due to their size. They often wade in pools or lakes to cool off.
    - Their hides sell for thousands
- Moosemen
    - Moosemen are an evolved form of Moose that are now bipedal. Standing well over 10 feet tall, the moosemen do not appear to be fully intelligent, and thus should not be mistaken for humans
    - Prefer night time for some reason
- Superspiders
    - Superspiders, as the name implies, are large evolved spiders. Their webs make for great rope, but their bites make for fatal encounters.

Danger Level 3

These creatures offer the greatest threat to human life in the wasteland, and travelers rarely survive to tell stories of them

- Bubblebear
    - The bubble bear is an evolved grizzly bear that has large bubble shaped bumps on its back, which occasionally burst to release psychoactive compounds that can cause hallucinations
    - The chemicals can be refined into brghhh, the wasteland's rarest and most prized drug. Sells for thousands.
- Spider Bear
    - The spider bear is another bear species that evolved 4 extra limbs. Self explanatory. Does not produce webs.
- Land Shark
    - Sharks which have evolved the ability to walk and breathe out of water for short periods. Only dangerous near water. Very strong bite force.

    - Soup can be made from their flesh.
- Crocigator
    - The Crocigator is a horrifying cross between an alligator and crocodile. It has two heads, one crocodile head and one alligator head. Do not get them mixed up, as the brain is in the alligator head and the crocodile head is full of its eggs, which sell for lots of money.
    - The best tip to tell which head is which is to wave raw salmon near it. Only the alligator head likes raw salmon. The crocodile head prefers halibut.
- Mindwolf
    - The mindwolf is a mutant wolf which has evolved a strong, mind disrupting magnetic field. Getting too close to a mindwolf causes hallucinations, vomiting, nausea, and sometimes temporary paralysis. The alpha is most dangerous.

Danger Level 4

The following creatures are so remarkably dangerous they don't seem real.

- The Mothman (men?)
    - In the rocky mountains, reports of a large moth with massive glowing eyes has been reported picking up and eating moosemen, humans, and sometimes inanimate valuables.
    - Likes to visit libraries? Need to fact check this…
    - Unclear if there is only one, or multiple
    - Intelligence and sentience unknown
- Nightcrawlers
    - Nightcrawlers are large, frog-like creatures. They are entirely white, are only spotted at night, and are known to kill people by grabbing them with their long ass tongues.
    - They only have two legs, and no arms.
- Chupacabra
    - Unlike the chupacabra of myth, which is kinda small, the real life chupacabra is the size of an adult bear, but way faster and resembles something like a coyote
    - Eats everything whole. No matter what.

- Wendigo
    - Wendigo appear at a distance to be skulldeer, but they walk on two legs, and have incredibly long and slender limbs
    - Reports indicate that rather than killing humans, they will kidnap them and force them to starve to death, even going out of their way to provide water to humans so that they don't first die of thirst.
    - Demonstrated ability to cloak or otherwise go kinda invisible
- Flatwoods Monsters
    - Flatwoods Monsters look like little aliens, and for all we know, they might be.
    - Incredibly rare, though reports indicate they may have a primitive language, and the ability to give humans suicidal ideations.
    - Not physically very dangerous, but they will try to convince you to kill yourself.
- Thunderbirds

    - Thunderbirds appear to be massive evolved eagles with abilities similar to electric eels. They are capable of delivering electric shocks, and can even generate such a large charge that they can produce lightning between themselves and the ground
- Wooly Throatstabbers
    - Wooly Throatstabbers are six limbed bipedal monsters which have two special limbs with no fingers, instead having long stabbing talons. They are precise with their stabbings, and have killed several travelers.

Skills

Skills are a measure of specific tasks characters are proficient in.
See proficiency and expertise rules for more info on applying skills.

Skill	Ability Modifier
Acrobatics	Dexterity
Animal Handling	Wisdom
Hacking	Intelligence
Athletics	Strength
Deception	Charisma
History	Intelligence
Insight	Wisdom
Intimidation	Charisma
Investigation	Intelligence

Medicine	Wisdom
Nature	Intelligence
Perception	Wisdom
Performance	Charisma
Persuasion	Charisma
Religion	Intelligence
Sleight of Hand	Dexterity
Stealth	Dexterity
Survival	Wisdom

Feats

Characters gain one Feat at levels 3, 6, 9, and 12.

Feats represent specialized training, unusual talents, practical experience, or personal eccentricities acquired while surviving the wasteland.

Unless otherwise specified, a character may select any Feat regardless of class.

A character cannot select the same Feat more than once unless its description explicitly allows it.

When a Feat grants proficiency in something the character is already proficient in, that character gains expertise in that skill, or they may instead select a different eligible proficiency instead, where applicable.

Feats do not consume class resources unless explicitly stated.

Feat	Effect
Sidearm Training	Gain proficiency with Sidearms, including throwables.
Long Gun Training	Gain proficiency with Long Guns.
Heavy Weapons Training	Gain proficiency with Heavy Weapons.
Melee Training	Gain proficiency with Melee Weapons.
Athletic Training	Gain proficiency in Athletics and increase movement speed by 5 ft.

Acrobatic Training	Gain proficiency in Acrobatics; standing from prone costs only 5 ft of movement.
Stealth Training	Gain proficiency in Stealth; gain +2 to Initiative rolls.
Survival Training	Gain proficiency in Survival; ordinary difficult terrain no longer slows your movement.
Medical Training	Gain proficiency in Medicine; gain advantage on checks to treat ordinary injuries.
Technical Training	Gain proficiency in Hacking; gain advantage on checks to repair ordinary electronics.

Investigative Training	Gain proficiency in Investigation; gain advantage on checks to search a specific object or container.
Diplomatic Training	Gain proficiency in Persuasion; gain advantage when negotiating ordinary commercial transactions.
Deception Training	Gain proficiency in Deception; gain advantage when maintaining a prepared false identity.
Intimidation Training	Gain proficiency in Intimidation; gain advantage when interrogating an isolated, frightened target.
Scholarly Training	Gain proficiency in History or Religion; gain proficiency in one additional Intelligence-based skill.

Animal Training	Gain proficiency in Animal Handling; ordinary domesticated animals are less likely to react aggressively toward you.
Toughness	Increase maximum HP by 2 per character level, including previous levels.
Armor Familiarity	Increase the AC bonus provided by armor you wear by +1.
Sharpshooter Training	Gain +1 accuracy with ranged weapon attacks.
Close-Quarters Training	Gain +1 accuracy with melee attacks and unarmed strikes.
Built Different	Once per long rest, when damage would reduce you to 0 HP, remain at 1 HP instead.

OSHA Violation	Gain advantage on checks involving improvised machinery, dangerous tools, and unsafe construction. Your improvised melee weapons deal +2 damage.
Menace	After successfully intimidating a creature, gain advantage on your next attack against that creature before the end of your next turn.
Coward	When combat begins, you may immediately move up to half your movement speed before the first turn, provided you move away from a visible enemy.
Unlicensed Pharmacist	When administering a drug or stimulant to another creature, you may increase one beneficial numerical effect by 50%, rounded up. Any negative side effects also increase by 50%, where applicable.

Rad Enthusiast	When a radioactive side effect would affect you, roll twice on the radioactive side-effect table and choose which result applies.
Union Representative	Once per long rest, you may give a short speech to up to five allies. Each gains temporary HP equal to your Charisma modifier + Proficiency Bonus, minimum 1.
Scrap Genius	Given 10 minutes and suitable scrap, you can temporarily repair a broken ordinary mechanical device. It functions for one hour before requiring proper repairs.
Bad Influence	When you succeed on a Deception or Persuasion check to convince someone to do something foolish, one ally who witnesses it gains advantage on their next Charisma check against that person.

I Meant To Do That	Once per long rest, after failing an ability check by 3 or less, you may declare that the failure was intentional. The check succeeds, but the GM introduces a minor, inconvenient consequence.

Basic Combat Rules

In addition to the written class rules for each class, all classes share a few things:

Every time a character levels up, they gain +1 to any two stats they choose (or +2 to one stat).

On levels 3, 6, 9 and 12, they gain a Feat

Level 12 is the max level

Core Character and Combat Rules

Ability Scores

Every character possesses six ability scores representing their natural capabilities.

- Strength (STR): Physical power, lifting, grappling, and brute force.
- Dexterity (DEX): Reflexes, precision, coordination, and agility.
- Constitution (CON): Endurance, toughness, resistance to poison, disease, and physical punishment.
- Intelligence (INT): Reasoning, technical knowledge, investigation, and scientific understanding.
- Wisdom (WIS): Awareness, intuition, judgment, and perception.
- Charisma (CHA): Persuasion, intimidation, deception, and force of personality.

Ability scores determine modifiers using the following formula:

Ability Modifier = floor((Ability Score - 10) / 2)

Ability Score	Modifier
1	-5
2-3	-4
4-5	-3
6-7	-2
8-9	-1
10-11	+0
12-13	+1
14-15	+2
16-17	+3
18-19	+4
20-21	+5
22-23	+6
24-25	+7

Starting Ability Scores

At character creation, players may choose either the Standard Array or Point Buy method. Both methods provide equivalent starting ability scores.

Standard Array: Assign the following six scores to the six abilities in any order:

15, 14, 13, 12, 10, 8

Point Buy: Players receive 27 points to distribute among their six ability scores. Every ability begins at 8, and no ability may exceed 15 during character creation.

Ability Score	Point Cost
8	0
9	1

10	2
11	3
12	4
13	5
14	7
15	9

Both methods use the same point budget, although Point Buy allows players to distribute their scores differently.

Attack Rolls

When a character attempts to strike, shoot, stab, pulverize, or otherwise injure a creature, they make an attack roll.

Attack Roll = d20 + Attack Ability Modifier + Proficiency Bonus (if proficient)

The attack succeeds if its total equals or exceeds the target's Armor Class (AC).

An attack roll represents more than whether a weapon physically makes contact. A failed attack might miss entirely, glance off armor, be dodged, or strike without causing meaningful injury.

Attack Ability Modifiers

- Melee weapons: Strength
- Ranged weapons: Dexterity
- Unarmed attacks: Strength
- Thrown weapons: Strength, unless the weapon specifies otherwise
- Finesse weapons: Strength or Dexterity, chosen by the attacker

Individual weapons, mutations, and class abilities may specify alternative ability modifiers.

Weapon Proficiency

A character adds their Proficiency Bonus to attacks made with weapons they are proficient in. Attacks with unfamiliar weapons can still be attempted, but do not receive the Proficiency Bonus.

Natural 20s and Natural 1s

A natural 20 on an attack roll always hits and is a Critical Hit, regardless of the target's AC.

A natural 1 on an attack roll always misses, regardless of modifiers.

Natural 20s and natural 1s do not automatically succeed or fail on ordinary ability checks. The GM may introduce exceptional narrative consequences where appropriate.

When a character has advantage, they roll two d20s and use the higher result. When they have disadvantage, they roll two d20s and use the lower result.

Multiple sources of advantage do not stack. Multiple sources of disadvantage do not stack. If both advantage and disadvantage apply, they cancel, regardless of how many sources of each are present.

Damage and Critical Hits

When an attack hits, the attacker rolls the weapon's damage dice and adds the appropriate ability modifier.

Damage = Weapon Damage Dice + Attack Ability Modifier + Other Applicable Bonuses

Damage cannot be reduced below zero. Damage reduces the target's current HP.

Weapon damage dice are determined by the weapon being used. Particularly powerful weapons,

explosives, mutations, and class abilities may use additional dice or special damage rules.

Critical Hits

When an attack scores a Critical Hit, roll twice the normal number of damage dice.

For example, a weapon that normally deals 2d6 + 3 damage instead deals 4d6 + 3 on a Critical Hit.

Flat modifiers are not doubled unless an ability explicitly states otherwise.

Damage Types

Damage may be described as ballistic, slashing, piercing, bludgeoning, fire, cold, electrical, chemical, radiation, psychic, energy, blast, or another appropriate type at DM discretion.

Damage types have no special mechanical effect by default. However, creatures, armor, equipment, mutations, and abilities may provide resistance, vulnerability, or immunity to particular types.

- Resistance: Halve incoming damage of the specified type, rounding down.
- Vulnerability: Double incoming damage of the specified type.
- Immunity: Take no damage of the specified type.

Radiation Damage

Whenever a creature takes radiation damage from a weapon, if the unmodified to-hit (or placement, for area attacks) check was 15 or higher and the attack hit, the target suffers some extra radioactive effects. If the unmodified to-hit(or placement, for area attacks) check was 5 or lower, the attacker makes the check, as their weapon has betrayed them.

Radioactive side effects

Side effects are one of the 12 following options. Roll a D12 to determine which one.

1 Glowstick

The target glows bright green for 3 turns. It cannot benefit from being invisible or hidden in darkness.

2 Nuclear Hiccups

The target emits radioactive hiccups. Disadvantage on Stealth checks for 3 turns.

3 Magnetic Personality

Loose metal objects cling to the target. Movement speed is reduced by 10 ft for 2 turns.

4 Bone Rattle

The target's skeleton vibrates violently. Disadvantage on its next attack roll.

5 Radioactive Flatulence

A 10-ft cloud forms around the target. Creatures inside must make a CON save or

become Poisoned until the end of their next turn.

6 Third Eye

The target temporarily grows an extra eye. Advantage on Perception checks for 3 turns.

7 Meat Magnet

The target becomes unnaturally attractive to nearby hostile creatures. Enemies have advantage on their next attack against it.

8 Unscheduled Growth

One limb doubles in size for 3 turns. The target gains +2 melee damage but disadvantage on Dexterity checks.

9 Geiger Counter

The target emits loud clicking sounds for 3 turns, revealing its approximate location.

10 Sudden Evolution

The target gains +10 ft movement speed for 2 turns. Its next movement must be in a straight line.

11 Atomic Sneeze

The target violently sneezes radioactive mucus. Every creature within 5 ft takes 1d4 radiation damage, including allies.

12 Critical Mass

The target immediately suffers another 1d6 radiation damage. Roll again on this table, ignoring another result of Critical Mass.

Damage and Healing

A creature's current HP cannot exceed its maximum HP.

When a creature receives healing, it regains the specified amount of HP, up to its maximum. Healing has no effect on a dead creature unless the effect explicitly allows revival.

Death and Mutation Revival

There is no downed or dying state in 501 Rads.

When a character's HP reaches 0, they immediately die. They do not fall unconscious, make death saving throws, or receive an opportunity to stabilize.

Death immediately initiates the Mutation Revival process, as described in the mutation rules. This entails a 30 minute wait and a new negative mutation, reviving with 1 hp.

Characters cannot be restored through ordinary healing once they have died. Extraordinary

abilities may interact with death or revival only when explicitly permitted by their descriptions.

A character who returns through Mutation Revival suffers whatever consequences that process entails.

There is no distinction between ordinary lethal damage and massive damage. Any attack or effect that reduces a character to 0 HP is lethal.

Total Bodily Destruction:

Mutation Revival occurs regardless of the extent of bodily damage. A character may regenerate from dismemberment, incineration, vaporization, or even complete atomic disintegration.

After 30 minutes, the character is fully reconstituted with 1 HP and gains one negative mutation, following the normal Mutation Revival rules.

No physical remains are required. The mechanism behind this phenomenon is unknown, poorly understood, and frankly none of your business.

The Game Master determines where the character reconstitutes if their original location is inaccessible or otherwise unsuitable.

Skills and Proficiency

Skills represent specific areas of training, experience, and practical competence.

When a character attempts a task with an uncertain outcome, the GM may request an ability check.

Ability Check = d20 + Relevant Ability Modifier + Proficiency Bonus (if proficient)

The GM determines which ability and skill are most appropriate to the task. Players may suggest alternative approaches, but the GM makes the final determination.

The GM should not require a roll for tasks that are trivial, impossible, or have no meaningful consequences for failure. The GM should not allow rolls for actions that will never be possible.

Starting Skill Proficiencies

At level 1, every character chooses four skills in which they are proficient.

Two of these must use one of the character's primary class ability scores as their usual modifier. The other two may be chosen freely.

A proficient character adds their Proficiency Bonus to checks involving that skill.

Characters cannot select the same proficiency twice to receive a double bonus.

Saving Throw Proficiencies

Each class is proficient in saving throws using its two primary ability scores.

Class	Saving Throw Proficiencies
Gunslinger	Dexterity, Charisma
Psycho	Strength, Charisma
Hacker	Dexterity, Intelligence
Medic	Constitution, Intelligence
Soldier	Strength, Wisdom
Prophet	Dexterity, Wisdom

When making a saving throw in which they are proficient, characters add their Proficiency Bonus to the relevant ability modifier.

Saving Throw = d20 + Ability Modifier + Proficiency Bonus (if proficient)

Expertise

Expertise represents extraordinary specialization in a skill.

A character with Expertise adds twice their Proficiency Bonus, rather than the normal amount, when making checks using that skill.

Expertise is not granted automatically. It must be acquired through a feat, class ability, mutation, or other explicitly defined feature.

Expertise never stacks with itself.

Proficiency and Expertise Through Feats

When a character selects a Feat that grants proficiency in a skill or weapon category, the following rules apply:

- Not Proficient: The character gains proficiency in the specified skill or weapon category.

- Already Proficient: The character instead gains Expertise in the specified skill or weapon category.
- Already an Expert: The Feat provides no additional proficiency benefit.

Expertise doubles the character's Proficiency Bonus for the relevant skill checks or weapon attack rolls. Expertise does not stack with itself.

A character may select each Feat only once. Consequently, characters cannot acquire Expertise by selecting the same training Feat twice.

Feats that grant a choice of proficiencies require the character to select which proficiency receives the benefit when the Feat is acquired.

Character Statistics

Every class in 501 Rads has its own base Hit Points (HP), Hit Die, Armor Class (AC), and Movement Speed. These statistics reflect the

natural strengths and weaknesses of each class. Characters improve their survivability through leveling, ability scores, equipment, and class abilities.

Class Statistics

Class	Primary Stats	Hit Die	Level 1 HP	Fixed HP / Level	Base AC	Unarmored AC Cap	Movement
Gunslinger	DEX / CHA	d8	8 + CON mod	5 + CON mod	7	18	35 ft
Psycho	STR / CHA	d12	12 + CON mod	7 + CON mod	9	20	40 ft
Hacker	DEX / INT	d6	6 + CON mod	4 + CON mod	6	16	30 ft
Medic	CON / INT	d10	10 + CON mod	6 + CON mod	7	18	30 ft
Soldier	STR / WIS	d12	12 + CON mod	7 + CON mod	8	20	35 ft
Prophet	DEX / WIS	d8	8 + CON mod	5 + CON mod	7	16	25 ft

Hit Points and Leveling

At level 1, characters receive the maximum value of their class's Hit Die plus their Constitution modifier. At every subsequent level, they may either roll their class's Hit Die or take the

fixed HP increase listed above, adding their Constitution modifier in either case. Characters always gain at least 1 maximum HP per level.

If a character's Constitution modifier increases or decreases, their maximum HP is adjusted retroactively by 1 HP per character level for each point of modifier change.

During a short rest, characters may spend available Hit Dice to recover HP. Characters have a number of Hit Dice equal to their character level, and each spent die restores the amount rolled plus their Constitution modifier, to a minimum of 1 HP. Long rests restore all HP and spent Hit Dice.

Armor Class

Armor Class determines how difficult a character is to hit. Unlike systems where armor establishes a fixed AC, armor in 501 Rads provides a bonus to the character's natural defenses.

AC = min(Base Class AC + Primary Physical Stat Modifier, Unarmored AC Cap) + Armor Bonus

Each class uses its designated primary physical ability score to calculate AC: Strength for Psychos and Soldiers, Constitution for Medics, and Dexterity for Gunslingers, Hackers, and Prophets.

The unarmored AC cap limits the combined contribution of base class AC and the primary physical modifier. Armor bonuses are applied afterward and may raise a character's AC above that cap.

Armor Category	AC Bonus
Ordinary clothing	+0
Light armor	+1
Medium armor	+2
Heavy armor	+3

Powered armor	+4

Armor bonuses do not stack unless an item or ability explicitly states otherwise. The highest possible AC from these standard rules is 24, achieved by a Psycho or Soldier at their unarmored cap while wearing powered armor. Exceptional equipment, mutations, or abilities may modify AC further if explicitly permitted.

Movement

Movement Speed represents the distance a character can move during their turn without sacrificing their normal action. Characters may move up to their listed speed and still perform an action.

A character may spend their action to Dash, moving an additional distance equal to their Movement Speed. Difficult terrain, crawling, swimming, and climbing cost twice the normal movement distance unless an ability states otherwise. Standing from prone costs half the

character's Movement Speed. Diagonal movement is measured using ordinary distance.

Movement Speed is not directly increased by ability score modifiers. Class abilities, mutations, equipment, and temporary effects may modify movement.

Combat Philosophy

Combat in 501 Rads is intended to be volatile, decisive, and dangerous. Even successful encounters may leave combatants injured or dead. Characters are expected to be hit relatively frequently, and victory should depend on preparation, positioning, equipment, teamwork, and the effective use of abilities rather than simply having a large pool of HP.

As characters advance, their defenses and survivability improve considerably, but higher-level enemies become correspondingly more dangerous. Powerful enemies should threaten experienced characters through devastating attacks, unusual abilities, and tactical

advantages rather than relying exclusively on enormous HP pools.

Actions, Class Resources, and Saving Throws

Class Resource Generation

Each class possesses a unique resource used to activate its special abilities: Heat (Gunslinger), Tolerance (Psycho), Access (Hacker), Malpractice (Medic), Authority (Soldier), or Faith (Prophet). These resources are earned through meaningful actions, successful checks, and class-specific accomplishments, as described in each class's rules.

Resource farming is prohibited. Characters cannot repeatedly perform trivial, inconsequential, or substantially identical actions for the purpose of generating class resources. The Game Master determines whether an action meaningfully qualifies for a resource

award. Multiple resource awards may result from a single event when the qualifying accomplishments are distinct, such as landing a killing blow that awards resources for both hitting and defeating an enemy.

Resources are awarded after the triggering action resolves. Characters cannot spend more resources than they currently possess, and cannot accumulate resources beyond their class's current maximum. Class resources reset to zero following a long rest.

Class Ability Clarifications

All classes share the same two initial class abilities, though under different names. Unlike all other class abilities, which require either a reactor or skill action point to use, these abilities cost no action points to use, and are used in conjunction with other events. For either of them, you may use them any time you

are prompted to roll a check.

Stacking Resource Triggers

A single action may generate class resources from multiple qualifying triggers. Each distinct trigger awards its full resource amount.

For example, a Hacker who successfully bypasses an electronic security system using an Intelligence-based Hacking check earns:

- +1 Access for succeeding on an Intelligence check.
- +1 Access for successfully bypassing an electronic security system.
- Total: +2 Access.

This applies to all classes. Resource generation remains subject to the character's maximum resource capacity and the existing prohibition against farming resources through trivial or repetitive actions. Class resources generated in excess of the maximum simply do nothing.

Action Economy

During each combat turn, a character receives the following:

Turn Component	Quantity	Purpose
Action	1	Attack, perform a complex task, interact with the environment, or take another substantial action
Movement	1	Move up to the character's Movement Speed
Bonus Action	1	Perform a quick action, minor interaction, or maneuver permitted by the rules
Skill Action	1	Activate a class ability, whether or not it consumes class resources

Reaction	1 per round	Respond to an event using an ability or action that explicitly permits a reaction

Characters may perform their available turn components in any order and may divide their movement before, between, or after other actions. Unused actions do not carry over into future turns.

Skill Actions are reserved for activating class abilities. Activating an ability normally consumes one Skill Action, regardless of its resource cost. Passive class abilities function automatically and do not consume Skill Actions. Abilities with specified preparation times, such as surgery or lengthy technical procedures, still require that time to complete.

Reactions occur in response to specific triggering events, including events outside the character's own turn. A character regains their Reaction at the beginning of their next turn. Class abilities explicitly described as

reactions consume a Reaction instead of a Skill Action, unless otherwise stated.

Effect Stacking: Multiple instances of the same effect do not stack unless explicitly stated otherwise. Reapplying an effect refreshes its duration but does not increase its strength. Different effects may stack, even when they provide similar benefits, unless their descriptions specify otherwise.

Saving Throws

When an ability requires a target to resist its effects, the target makes a saving throw using the ability score specified by that effect.

The difficulty of resisting a character's ability is determined by the character using it:

Ability Save DC = 8 + Relevant Ability Modifier + Proficiency Bonus

The relevant ability modifier is determined by the class ability being used. It is generally

one of the class's primary ability scores, but individual abilities may specify otherwise.

The defending creature rolls:

Saving Throw = d20 + Relevant Saving Throw Modifier

A saving throw succeeds when its result equals or exceeds the Ability Save DC. On a failure, the creature suffers the effect described by the ability. Unless otherwise stated, a successful save prevents the effect entirely.

Proficiency Bonus

Proficiency represents a character's developing competence and contributes to the difficulty of resisting their class abilities.

Character Level	Proficiency Bonus
1–4	+2

5–8	+3
9–12	+4

The proficiency bonus also applies to other proficient checks, attacks, and saving throws as specified by the broader rules.

Ability Ranges

All distances in 501 Rads are measured in feet. Unless an ability specifies otherwise, a creature must be within the stated range when the ability is activated. An ability that requires sight cannot target a creature behind an opaque obstruction, even if the creature is within range.

Abilities that specify touch require physical contact. Abilities affecting the user alone have a range of Self. Abilities without a stated range or target requirement are governed by

their individual descriptions.

Initiative

When combat begins, every participant rolls Initiative:

Initiative = d20 + Dexterity Modifier

Combat proceeds from highest Initiative to lowest. Ties are resolved by the higher Dexterity score. Remaining ties are resolved by the Game Master.

Each participant takes one turn per round. Once every participant has taken a turn, a new round begins in the same Initiative order.

A round represents approximately six seconds.

Surprise: A creature unaware of an imminent attack is Surprised. A Surprised creature cannot take Actions, Bonus Actions, Skill Actions, or Movement during its first turn, and cannot take Reactions until that turn ends.

The Game Master determines surprise based on circumstances, potentially using Stealth and Perception checks.

Cover

Cover represents physical obstacles that interfere with attacks.

- Partial Cover: +2 AC and +2 to Dexterity saving throws against effects obstructed by the cover.
- Substantial Cover: +5 AC and +5 to Dexterity saving throws against effects obstructed by the cover.
- Total Cover: A creature cannot be directly targeted by attacks originating on the opposite side of the obstruction.

Cover bonuses do not stack. A creature benefits from only the strongest applicable cover.

Cover applies based on the direction of the attack or effect. A creature may have cover from one attacker but not another.

Area effects may bypass cover when their point of origin is on the same side as the protected creature. Particularly powerful weapons may destroy cover, as determined by the Game Master.

Conditions

Condition	Mechanical effect
Blinded	Disadvantage on attacks; attacks against you have advantage
Deafened	Cannot hear; automatically fail checks requiring hearing
Poisoned	Disadvantage on attacks and ability checks
Prone	Melee attacks within 5 ft have advantage; attacks from farther away

	have disadvantage; standing costs half movement
Restrained	Movement 0; attacks against you have advantage; your attacks and DEX saves have disadvantage
Stunned	Cannot take Actions, Bonus Actions, Skill Actions, Movement, or Reactions; attacks against you have advantage
Incapacitated	Cannot take Actions, Bonus Actions, Skill Actions, or Reactions, but may move unless another effect prevents it
Frightened	Disadvantage on attacks and checks while the source of fear is visible; cannot willingly move closer
Burning	Takes 1d6 fire damage at the beginning of each turn until extinguished

Irradiated	Subject to a radioactive side effect as specified by the source

Entities affected with burning can spend 1 action to extinguish flames. Environmental effects, like bodies of water, can end the condition early.

Classes

Gunslinger

The gunslinger is the wild, gun toting cowboy of the American wasteland. Quick, both in body and wit, the gunslinger relies on distraction, positioning, and wild antics to survive in the wasteland. Gunslingers specialize in pistols and grenades, as well as in charm and smooth talking.

Gunslingers are all about hot streaks. They always seem to get lucky, and their luck tends to last.

It is recommended that gunslingers focus stat points into Dex and Cha.

Enemies who make saving throws as a result of the Gunslinger's abilities make those saves against the Gunslinger's dexterity.

Primary Class Feature: Gunslingers gain access to "heat" points. Gunslingers can earn heat points towards their hot streak, and spend those points to use powerful abilities.

Gunslingers earn a heat point for any of the following, though dungeon masters can award extra points at will:
+1 For a successful Charisma check or save
+1 For a successful Dexterity check or save
+1 For landing a hit with a pistol weapon

+1 For landing a hit with a grenade (stacks)
+2 For killing an opponent with a pistol or grenade

As the character levels up, they increase their maximum heat, as well as unlock new abilities with that heat. Heat resets after a long rest.

Level 1: Level 1 gunslingers gain access to the first two heat abilities, and at level 1 have a max heat of 3.
Lucky strike; for -1 heat, the user can re-roll any check. They must take the new value.

Stroke of Genius; for -3 heat, the user can roll 3 dice instead of one for any check, and select which dice they wish. (It's like double advantage!)

In addition, gunslingers get +1 to checks and damage rolls done with pistols.

Level 2: At level 2, gunslingers unlock the following

Fan the Hammer; For -2 heat points, the gunslinger can fire several times in short succession. The gunslinger's next attack with a pistol has its damage multiplied by 3, but the gunslinger must announce before that attack that this ability is being used. You can still miss!

Level 3: Max heat increases from 3 to 5, and the gunslinger unlocks the ability to wield two pistols at once. Both pistols may attack within the same action

Level 4: At level 4, the gunslinger unlocks the following:

Distraction: for -2 heat, the gunslinger can choose any target that a teammate has already done damage to since the gunslingers previous turn. That teammate has “distracted” this opponent. For the remainder of this turn, any

checks made to harm the target have advantage, and attacks made with pistols are guaranteed to hit. The same target cannot be distracted more than once.

Pickpocket: for -2 heat, when outside or inside combat, the gunslinger can pickpocket any target. If the target is known to have something on their person, the gunslinger can grab it. Otherwise, they can grab something random from the target. The target rolls a D20 to detect the intrusion, and only is aware if they roll a perfect 20.

Level 5: at level 5, max heat increases to 7

Deadeye: for -5 heat, the gunslinger chooses any non-boss target. On the gunslinger's next turn, if both the gunslinger and the target are still alive, and the gunslinger has line of sight to the target, the gunslinger fires a deadly shot. It always kills the target. To activate deadeye, you cannot take any other action, nor can you

move. Being moved by any means interrupts the effect, and the heat is not refunded.

Level 6: At level 6, the gunslinger unlocks the following

Shrouded attack: if the gunslinger is not detected by enemies, they gain advantage on checks to harm them

Fantastic Story: for -4 heat, the gunslinger can cobble together a nonsensical story. Despite how crazy it sounds, a portion of it is true. The part of it that is true is at the DM's discretion, but the effect is always helpful to the gunslinger. Gunslingers can tell fantastic stories to distract, persuade, or intimidate their enemies.

Level 7: at level 7, max heat increases to 9, and the amount of heat added doubles whenever heat would be added. (i.e. +2 for successful checks, etc)

No one walks away: for -7 heat, the gunslinger pulls an excellent stunt. For any number of targets that the gunslinger can see, the gunslinger fires twice at them. There is no limit to the number of targets.

Level 8: at level 8, the following effects are added

Master Gambler: gunslingers have advantage on any check that involves the gambling of money or property

Old friend: for -5 heat, the gambler happens upon an old friend. The friend is helpful, knowledgeable, and useful. They always have some favor they owe the gunslinger. The gunslinger has friends everywhere.

Level 9: At level 9, max heat becomes 11

Bending Bullets: The gunslinger can now hit targets in cover/they cannot see by accidentally ricocheting shots into them. Attempts to hit in this way incur a -3 to hit penalty.

Wild Plan: For -8 heat, the gunslinger can devise a wild plan. They alone have final say on that plan. As long as the steps of that plan are followed by the gunslinger and their teammates, any skill checks which follow the steps of the plan or advance the plan in some way have advantage.

Level 10: At level 10, the following abilities are gained

Super Deadeye: for -11 heat, any target, including bosses, can be targeted. If a boss is targeted, the effect works the same as normal deadeye. If a non-boss target is chosen, the gunslinger does not have to wait a full turn, the target simply dies.

Level 11: At level 11, there is no longer a maximum heat value.

Unbelievable luck: For -10 heat, any non-plot item happens to be nearby. It might not be easy to get, but it will be there. It's almost like you wished it into existence

Level 12: At level 12, the amount of heat added triples whenever heat would be added. (i.e. +3 for successful checks, etc)

Divine Intervention: for -15 heat the gunslinger can wish for just about anything and somehow it happens. The ultimate stroke of luck. Each time this ability is used, the probability that an unintended consequence occurs increases.

Psycho

The Psycho is the eternal drug overdose who feels no pain (because of the drugs). They

tactically mix drugs to become the ultimate utility, but usually that utility is violent and loud

Psychos are about pushing their system to the limit, taking as many drugs as they can tolerate

It is recommended that psychos focus stat points into Str and Cha.

Enemies who make saving throws as a result of the Psycho's abilities make those saves against the Psycho's Strength.

If a psycho refreshes an ability that would incur a negative side effect upon its termination, that negative side effect is delayed, and the duration of the negative side effect is unchanged. The same is true for the side effects of normal consumable drugs, an ability which is unique to the Psycho. Keep reupping those drugs!

Primary Class Feature: Psychos gain access to “tolerance” points. Psychos can earn tolerance points towards taking more powerful drugs, and spend those points to use powerful abilities.

Psychos earn a tolerance point for any of the following, though dungeon masters can award extra points at will:
+1 For a successful Charisma check or save
+1 For a successful Strength check or save
+1 For landing a hit with a melee weapon
+1 For landing a hit with a chemical weapon(stacks)
+2 For killing an opponent with a melee or chemical weapon

As the character levels up, they increase their maximum tolerance, as well as unlock new abilities with that tolerance. Tolerance resets after a long rest.

Level 1: Level 1 psychos gain access to the first two tolerance abilities, and at level 1 have a max tolerance of 3.
Ibuprofen; for -1 tolerance, the user can re-roll any check. They must take the new value.

Cocaine; for -3 tolerance, the user can roll 3 dice instead of one for any check, and select which dice they wish. (It's like double advantage!)

In addition, Psychos get +1 to checks and damage rolls done with melee weaponry.

Level 2: At level 2, psychos unlock the following

Heroin; For -2 tolerance points, the psycho reduces all incoming damage taken until their next turn by half. During this time, they have disadvantage on dexterity based checks.

Level 3: Max tolerance increases from 3 to 5, and the psycho unlocks the ability to wield furniture and other environmental objects as a melee weapon. Environmental weapons are up to DM discretion for power levels, but are usually surprisingly effective.

Level 4: At level 4, the psycho unlocks the following:

Meth: for -2 tolerance, the psycho can double his movement speed for three turns, as well as increase melee attack checks by +2. The user gets disadvantage on intelligence checks during the duration of the effect. Activating this ability while it is active extends the duration, but does not stack.

IntelliBoostPro: for -2 tolerance, the psycho gains advantage on all intelligence checks for 5 minutes, but disadvantage on strength checks during the span. When the effect ends, the effect flips, and the psycho gains advantage on strength

checks and disadvantage on intelligence checks, also for 5 minutes.

Level 5: at level 5, max tolerance increases to 7

Bromo-Dragonfly: for -5 tolerance, the psycho begins hallucinating. While hallucinating, the psycho can see the weak points of nearby people and objects, as well as the locations of nearby valuable items. While hallucinating, if the user takes any damage, their trip turns evil, and they must attack the nearest target every 15 seconds. The trip lasts 3 minutes.

Level 6: At level 6, the psycho unlocks the following

Incredible Intimidation: The mere presence of a psycho is unnerving. For each unspent tolerance point, the psycho gets +2 to intimidation checks.

DMT: for -4 tolerance, the psycho can see the emotions of everyone around them. They can tell a person is sad, angry, etc from far away with perfect accuracy, can detect lies, and can see particularly strong emotions through walls. Because of visual distortion, they have disadvantage on any check that relies on normal vision. This effect lasts 30 minutes.

Level 7: at level 7, max tolerance increases to 9, and the amount of tolerance added doubles whenever tolerance would be added. (i.e. +2 for successful checks, etc)

SuperSoldier: for -7 tolerance, the psycho flies into a combat rage. For the next 3 turns, they may take either an extra action or bonus action, move twice as fast, and have advantage on attack rolls. Once the 3 turns end, they pass out, and are unconscious for 2 turns.

Level 8: at level 8, the following effects are added

Chemical Immunity: the psycho becomes immune to inhaled or ingested poisons or chemicals, and can identify chemicals by tasting them.

OmegaMax: for -5 tolerance, the psycho becomes able to camouflage. It only works effectively when staying still, but is very effective when conditions are met. It lasts 20 mins, and at the end, the psycho glows bright green for 2 mins.

Level 9: At level 9, max tolerance becomes 11

Rage: Not being on drugs makes you really angry. You get +2 to strength checks per unspent tolerance, but -1 to intelligence, wisdom, and dexterity checks per unspent tolerance.

Jericho: For -8 tolerance, the psycho becomes obsessed with a target. While the effect is active, all checks made to harm the target are made with advantage, the psycho knows the precise location of the target, and deals double

damage to the target. While the effect is active, the psycho may not do any actions that don't result in harm to the target. The effect lasts 3 minutes or until the target is dead.

Level 10: At level 10, the following abilities are gained

UltraSoldier: for -11 tolerance, the psycho flies into an ultra combat rage. For the next 3 turns, they may take a sum of two additional actions or bonus actions, move three times as fast, and have advantage on attack rolls, and +4 on damage rolls. Once the 3 turns end, they pass out, and are unconscious for 3 turns.

Level 11: At level 11, there is no longer a maximum tolerance value.

Wrecking Ball: For -10 tolerance, the psycho gains the ability to run through solid objects as long as they are reasonably thin. This includes enemies, which they can run into to

deal damage and push away. This effect lasts 3 minutes.

Level 12: At level 12, the amount of tolerance added triples whenever tolerance would be added. (i.e. +3 for successful checks, etc)

UltraCocaMethMorphine: for -15 tolerance the psycho becomes invincible and immortal for 3 minutes.

Hacker

The Hacker is the technologically gifted menace of the American wasteland. While most wastelanders consider a functioning toaster to be a technological marvel, the Hacker is busy breaking into military computers, hijacking security robots, and figuring out how to make that toaster launch nuclear missiles. Hackers specialize in computers, electronics, mechanical devices, and the delicate art of making

expensive things do things they were never intended to do.

Hackers are all about access. Every successful intrusion, clever modification, or technological breakthrough gives them another foothold in the systems around them. The more access they gain, the more spectacular their exploits become.

It is recommended that Hackers focus stat points into Int and Dex.

Enemies who make saving throws as a result of the Hackers abilities make those saves against the Hacker's intelligence

Primary Class Feature: Hackers gain access to "Access" points. Hackers can earn Access points through successful technical actions and spend those points to use powerful abilities.

Hackers earn an Access point for any of the following, though dungeon masters can award extra points at will:

+1 For a successful Intelligence check or save

+1 For a successful Dexterity check or save

+1 For successfully hacking or bypassing an electronic security system

+1 For successfully disabling, repairing, or modifying a technological device

+1 For landing a hit with an electronic or energy weapon

+2 For successfully taking control of a hostile electronic system or robotic enemy

As the character levels up, they increase their maximum Access, as well as unlock new abilities with that Access. Access resets after a long rest.

Level 1: Level 1 Hackers gain access to the first two Access abilities, and at level 1 have a max Access of 3.

Have You Tried Turning It Off and On Again? For -1 Access, the Hacker can reroll any check. They must take the new value.

Administrator Privileges: For -3 Access, the Hacker can roll 3 dice instead of one for any check, and select which die they wish.

In addition, Hackers get +1 to checks involving hacking, repairing, or modifying electronic devices.

Level 2: At level 2, Hackers unlock the following:

Remote Access: For -2 Access, the Hacker can remotely interact with any electronic device they can see within 100 feet, as though they were physically connected to it. This includes computers, electronic locks, cameras, terminals, and similar devices. The Hacker must still make any checks ordinarily required to manipulate the device, and cannot access systems that have no electronic interface.

Level 3: Max Access increases from 3 to 5, and the Hacker unlocks the ability to construct improvised electronic devices from scavenged components. These devices can perform simple

functions such as recording audio, transmitting signals, detecting movement, or activating mechanical switches. The GM determines what components are required, but Hackers are exceptionally good at finding substitutes.

Level 4: At level 4, the Hacker unlocks the following:

Backdoor: For -2 Access, the Hacker can establish a hidden connection to an electronic system they have successfully accessed. For the next 24 hours, they can reconnect to that system without repeating the original security checks, provided the system remains operational and within communication range. Only one Backdoor may be maintained at a time.

Deepfake: For -2 Access, the Hacker can manipulate an electronic recording, image, or transmission to convincingly imitate another person, fabricate an event, or conceal information. The resulting forgery is convincing to ordinary observers, although sophisticated forensic examination may reveal inconsistencies.

Level 5: At level 5, max Access increases to 7.

Ghost in the Machine: For -5 Access, the Hacker can temporarily seize control of a nearby robotic device, automated turret, security drone, or similar machine for 5 minutes. The target must be electronically accessible and cannot be substantially more sophisticated than the Hacker's available equipment. While controlled, the machine obeys the Hacker's commands, although intelligent machines may attempt to resist or regain control at the GM's discretion.

Level 6: At level 6, the Hacker unlocks the following:

Technological Intuition: The Hacker can determine the general purpose, operational condition, and likely weaknesses of any technological device after examining it for one minute. They can also identify whether a device has been tampered with, sabotaged, or modified.

Digital Archaeology: For -4 Access, the Hacker can recover information from a damaged, corrupted, or partially destroyed electronic storage device. The recovered information may be incomplete, but always includes something useful if the device originally contained relevant data. The GM determines exactly what survives.

Level 7: At level 7, max Access increases to 9, and the amount of Access added doubles whenever Access would be added.

System Override: For -7 Access, the Hacker can seize control of all electronically controlled devices connected to a single local network for 3 minutes. This may include doors, cameras, alarms, lighting, automated defenses, and industrial equipment. Devices physically disconnected from the network are unaffected. Highly sophisticated security systems may resist particularly dangerous commands.

Level 8: At level 8, the following effects are added:

Walking Encyclopedia: Hackers have advantage on Intelligence checks involving pre-war technology, computer systems, robotics, and electronic infrastructure. They can also recognize the manufacturer and likely purpose of most surviving technological equipment.

Identity Theft: For -5 Access, the Hacker can fabricate a convincing electronic identity within a system they have accessed. For the next 24 hours, automated systems treat the Hacker as an authorized user with a plausible clearance level. Human observers may still become suspicious if the Hacker behaves inconsistently with their supposed identity.

Level 9: At level 9, max Access becomes 11.

Wireless Menace: The Hacker can now remotely access electronic systems within 350 feet, even without direct line of sight, provided they can detect or identify the target's electronic signal. Remote Access no longer requires visual contact.

Skeleton Key: For -8 Access, the Hacker can bypass almost any electronic security system they can access, including sophisticated military locks, encrypted databases, and corporate authentication systems. The bypass succeeds automatically unless the system is protected by an extraordinary or plot-critical security measure. The Hacker does not necessarily gain control of everything behind the security system.

Level 10: At level 10, the following abilities are gained:

Total System Failure: For -11 Access, the Hacker can cause a catastrophic malfunction in a technological system they can access. A power grid might collapse, an automated factory might destroy itself, or a military installation's defenses might turn against their operators. The GM determines the exact consequences based on the system's capabilities. The effect cannot create functions the system was never capable of performing.

Level 11: At level 11, there is no longer a maximum Access value.

I Know a Guy Who Knows a Guy: For -10 Access, the Hacker discovers a useful connection within an existing technological or communications network. This might be a forgotten administrative account, an abandoned maintenance terminal, a dormant satellite connection, or an overlooked communications relay. The connection always provides a meaningful advantage, although accessing it may require additional work.

Level 12: At level 12, the amount of Access added triples whenever Access would be added.

Root Access: For -15 Access, the Hacker gains near-absolute control over a single technological system they can access for 10 minutes. During this time, the Hacker can issue commands that bypass ordinary software restrictions, override security protocols, and exploit capabilities that even the system's designers may not have anticipated. The system must remain physically capable of performing the

requested actions, and the GM determines the consequences of particularly extraordinary commands. This can include vehicles, robots, factories, all sorts of things.

Medic

The Medic is the wasteland's foremost expert on the human body, or at least the foremost expert willing to operate without a license. A brilliant surgeon, deranged biologist, and walking violation of medical ethics, the Medic views the human body as an extraordinarily complicated machine that could probably be improved with enough scalpels, chemicals, and screaming.

Medics specialize in healing, biological experimentation, surgery, poisons, and the manipulation of living organisms. They can transform their allies into medical miracles and their enemies into cautionary tales.

Medics are all about malpractice. Every successful procedure, questionable experiment, and spectacular violation of the Hippocratic Oath brings them closer to their next breakthrough. Their methods may be horrifying, but their results are difficult to argue with.

It is recommended that Medics focus stat points into Con and Int.

Enemies who make saving throws as a result of the Medics abilities make those saves against the Medic's intelligence.

Primary Class Feature: Medics gain access to "Malpractice" points. Medics can earn Malpractice through successful medical actions and spend those points to perform powerful biological procedures.

Medics earn a Malpractice point for any of the following, though dungeon masters can award extra points at will:

+1 For a successful Intelligence check or save

+1 For a successful Constitution check or save

+1 For successfully diagnosing or treating an injury, illness, or biological condition

+1 For successfully administering a drug, poison, or biological treatment to another creature

+1 For successfully extracting useful biological information or material from a living organism

+2 For successfully saving a creature at less than 10% their base hp by raising their hp above 50% or incapacitating an enemy through a biological effect

As the character levels up, they increase their maximum Malpractice, as well as unlock new abilities with that Malpractice. Malpractice resets after a long rest.

Level 1: Level 1 Medics gain access to the first two Malpractice abilities, and at level 1 have a max Malpractice of 3.

Second Opinion: For -1 Malpractice, the Medic can reroll any check. They must take the new value.

Clinical Trial: For -3 Malpractice, the Medic can roll 3 dice instead of one for any check, and select which die they wish.

In addition, Medics get +1 to checks involving medicine, surgery, diagnosis, and the administration of biological treatments.

Level 2: At level 2, Medics unlock the following:

Questionable Prescription: For -2 Malpractice, the Medic administers a custom pharmaceutical cocktail to themselves or a willing creature they can touch. For the next 10 minutes, the recipient gains advantage on checks using one ability score of the Medic's choice. During this time, they have disadvantage on checks using another ability score, also chosen by the Medic. The recipient must be informed of neither choice.

Level 3: Max Malpractice increases from 3 to 5, and the Medic unlocks the ability to perform surgery under almost any circumstances. The

Medic can use improvised tools, perform procedures without a sterile environment, and stabilize critically injured patients using materials ordinarily considered unsuitable for medical purposes. The GM determines the difficulty of particularly extraordinary procedures.

Level 4: At level 4, the Medic unlocks the following:

Performance Enhancing Drugs: For -2 Malpractice, the Medic can inject themselves or a willing creature with an experimental stimulant. For the next 3 turns, the recipient gains +2 to attack checks and doubles their movement speed. When the effect ends, the recipient suffers disadvantage on Dexterity and Strength checks for 3 turns. Repeated applications extend the duration but do not stack.

Medical Examination: For -2 Malpractice, the Medic can determine the physical condition of any living creature they can examine for at least 30 seconds. The Medic learns about

injuries, diseases, poisons, mutations, biological weaknesses, and unusual physiological characteristics. They can also determine whether the creature has recently been exposed to radiation, drugs, or other biological contaminants. Particularly unusual conditions may require further investigation.

Level 5: At level 5, max Malpractice increases to 7.

Organ Donation: For -5 Malpractice, the Medic can temporarily transfer a biological characteristic from one willing creature to another. The Medic may transfer a sense, a natural physical adaptation, or a minor beneficial mutation. The donor loses access to the transferred characteristic for the duration, while the recipient gains it. The effect lasts 10 minutes, after which both creatures return to normal. The procedure cannot transfer major organs necessary for survival or extraordinary mutations at the GM's discretion. The procedure cannot ever transfer any effect or ability that

the target already has. If it does, there is no stacking, and the ability is effectively ignored. For example, giving someone an extra nose doesn't make them smell twice as well.

Level 6: At level 6, the Medic unlocks the following:

Anatomical Expertise: The Medic has advantage on checks involving identifying biological weaknesses, treating injuries, understanding unfamiliar organisms, and determining causes of death. Additionally, the Medic can identify the approximate age, health, and biological condition of a creature through careful observation.

Unlicensed Experimentation: For -4 Malpractice, the Medic can temporarily alter the physiology of a willing creature for 30 minutes. The Medic may give the recipient one of the following adaptations: the ability to breathe underwater, immunity to ordinary environmental temperatures, enhanced night vision, or the ability to survive without breathing. When the effect ends, the

recipient suffers a harmless but conspicuous biological side effect determined by the GM.

Level 7: At level 7, max Malpractice increases to 9, and the amount of Malpractice added doubles whenever Malpractice would be added.

Hippocratic Suggestion: For -7 Malpractice, the Medic can administer a powerful neurochemical treatment to a living creature they can touch. For the next 5 minutes, the target becomes extremely susceptible to suggestion and treats the Medic as a trusted medical authority. The Medic may issue reasonable instructions that the target will attempt to follow. Instructions that directly threaten the target's life or fundamentally contradict its strongest convictions may be resisted through a Wisdom save.

Level 8: At level 8, the following effects are added:

Doctor's Orders: The Medic has advantage on Charisma checks when presenting themselves as a

medical professional, explaining medical procedures, or convincing others that a situation constitutes a medical emergency. This applies even when the Medic's qualifications are completely fabricated.

Biological Sabotage: For -5 Malpractice, the Medic can administer a specialized biological agent to a living target they can touch or successfully inject. The target suffers one effect chosen by the Medic for 5 minutes: temporary blindness, loss of speech, severely reduced movement speed, or uncontrollable muscle spasms. The target may attempt a Constitution save to resist the effect. The procedure causes no permanent injury unless the GM determines otherwise.

Level 9: At level 9, max Malpractice becomes 11.

Mutational Medicine: The Medic gains the ability to temporarily suppress one negative mutation affecting a willing creature for 30 minutes. This requires one minute of examination and treatment. The mutation returns when the effect

ends. A creature can only benefit from one such suppression at a time.

Experimental Evolution: For -8 Malpractice, the Medic can temporarily amplify one positive mutation possessed by a willing creature for 10 minutes. The GM determines how the mutation improves, but the enhancement should be substantial and appropriate to the original effect. When the treatment ends, the mutation becomes inactive for 10 minutes as the recipient's body recovers.

Level 10: At level 10, the following abilities are gained:

Catastrophic Diagnosis: For -11 Malpractice, the Medic can identify and exploit a devastating biological vulnerability in a living creature they can observe. The Medic selects one target and announces a diagnosis. For the next 3 turns, the target suffers disadvantage on all physical checks and saves, takes double damage from attacks, and cannot regain HP through ordinary healing. The target may attempt a Constitution

save at the beginning of each turn to end the effect. The Medic must be able to see the target when activating this ability.

Level 11: At level 11, there is no longer a maximum Malpractice value.

Medical Miracle: For -10 Malpractice, the Medic can perform an extraordinary biological procedure that would ordinarily be considered impossible. Examples include restoring a lost limb, curing an otherwise incurable disease, reversing severe biological damage, or reconstructing a critically damaged organ. The procedure requires appropriate materials and at least 10 minutes of uninterrupted work. It cannot reverse death or permanently remove the radiation infection central to the campaign.

Level 12: At level 12, the amount of Malpractice added triples whenever Malpractice would be added.

God Complex: For -15 Malpractice, the Medic can completely rewrite the biological condition of a

single living creature they can touch. For the next 10 minutes, the Medic may impose extraordinary biological changes, including granting temporary physical adaptations, disabling major bodily functions, radically altering the creature's appearance, or transforming its physiology in ways that defy conventional medicine.

The changes must be biological in nature, and the GM determines the limits of particularly extreme transformations. Unwilling targets may attempt a Constitution save to resist the procedure. When the effect ends, the target returns to its original biological state, although the experience may leave lasting psychological consequences.

Soldier

The Soldier is a highly trained instrument of war, or at least someone who has spent enough

time around military equipment to convincingly impersonate one. A master of battlefield tactics, leadership, and organized violence, the Soldier understands that victory is rarely achieved through individual heroics. It is achieved through discipline, preparation, and convincing everyone else to do exactly what they're told.

Soldiers specialize in rifles, heavy weapons, defensive positions, leadership, and the coordination of their allies. They are equally comfortable organizing an assault on a fortified compound, training a group of terrified civilians, or explaining to an enemy why surrendering immediately would be in everyone's best interest.

Soldiers are all about authority. Every successful maneuver, decisive order, and demonstration of tactical competence strengthens their command over the battlefield. The more Authority they accumulate, the more extraordinary their leadership becomes.

It is recommended that Soldiers focus stat points into Str and Wis.

Enemies who make saving throws as a result of the Soldiers abilities make those saves against the soldier's wisdom

Primary Class Feature: Soldiers gain access to "Authority" points. Soldiers earn Authority through successful physical actions, tactical decisions, and leadership, and spend those points to use powerful abilities.

Soldiers earn an Authority point for any of the following, though dungeon masters can award extra points at will:

+1 For a successful Strength check or save

+1 For a successful Wisdom check or save

+1 For successfully assisting an ally with a check

+1 For landing a hit with a rifle or heavy weapon

+1 For successfully identifying or exploiting a tactical advantage

+2 For defeating an enemy through a coordinated attack involving at least one ally

As the character levels up, they increase their maximum Authority, as well as unlock new abilities with that Authority. Authority resets after a long rest.

Level 1: Level 1 Soldiers gain access to the first two Authority abilities, and at level 1 have a max Authority of 3.

Second Attempt, Soldier! For -1 Authority, the Soldier can reroll any check. They must take the new value.

Military Precision: For -3 Authority, the Soldier can roll 3 dice instead of one for any check, and select which die they wish.

In addition, Soldiers get +1 to checks and damage rolls made with rifles and heavy weapons.

Level 2: At level 2, Soldiers unlock the following:

Follow My Lead: For -2 Authority, the Soldier can designate one willing ally they can communicate with. For the next 3 turns, whenever the Soldier successfully makes a check using Strength or Wisdom, that ally gains advantage on their next check involving a similar task. Outside combat, this ability lasts 5 minutes.

Level 3: Max Authority increases from 3 to 5, and the Soldier unlocks the ability to use heavy weapons without suffering ordinary handling penalties. Additionally, the Soldier can organize improvised defensive positions using nearby terrain and materials. Given 10 minutes of preparation, the Soldier can create a defensible position that grants cover to nearby allies, subject to the environment and available resources.

Level 4: At level 4, the Soldier unlocks the following:

Suppressing Fire: For -2 Authority, the Soldier can designate an area they can see and fire a sustained burst of weapon fire into it. Until the beginning of their next turn, enemies attempting to move through the designated area must succeed on a Wisdom save or abandon their movement. Enemies that remain in cover are unaffected.

Command Presence: For -2 Authority, the Soldier can issue an authoritative command to a group of creatures who can hear and understand them. For the next 5 minutes, the Soldier gains advantage on Charisma checks involving organizing, directing, or negotiating with that group. Creatures who are actively hostile may resist the effect through a Wisdom save.

Level 5: At level 5, max Authority increases to 7.

Coordinated Assault: For -5 Authority, the Soldier can organize a coordinated attack involving themselves and up to three willing allies. Each participant may immediately make one attack against a target of their choice,

provided they are capable of attacking and can receive the Soldier's orders. These attacks have advantage. Each participant may only benefit from this ability once per round.

Level 6: At level 6, the Soldier unlocks the following:

Veteran's Instinct: The Soldier has advantage on Wisdom checks involving detecting ambushes, identifying military equipment, recognizing tactical formations, or evaluating the defensibility of a location. Additionally, the Soldier can determine whether an armed group appears professionally trained after observing them briefly.

Emergency Requisition: For -4 Authority, the Soldier can locate a useful piece of military equipment among nearby supplies, abandoned structures, or accessible storage. The item must plausibly exist in the area and cannot be exceptionally rare or plot-critical. The GM determines exactly where it is found, but the Soldier always knows where to look.

Level 7: At level 7, max Authority increases to 9, and the amount of Authority added doubles whenever Authority would be added.

Hold the Line: For -7 Authority, the Soldier can establish an extraordinarily effective defensive position. For the next 3 turns, the Soldier and up to five willing allies within 45 feet gain advantage on defensive saves and take half damage from ranged attacks while remaining in their designated positions. The effect ends for any participant who abandons their position.

Level 8: At level 8, the following effects are added:

Drill Sergeant: The Soldier can train willing creatures in basic combat skills, weapon handling, and battlefield discipline. After one hour of instruction, up to ten creatures gain +2 to their next three attack checks or relevant physical checks. The benefit expires after 24 hours.

Chain of Command: For -5 Authority, the Soldier can temporarily convince a group of non-hostile armed personnel that they possess legitimate military authority. For the next 10 minutes, the group treats the Soldier as a superior officer unless presented with convincing evidence otherwise. The effect works best on organized military or paramilitary groups and may fail against individuals who personally know the actual chain of command.

Level 9: At level 9, max Authority becomes 11.

Perfect Formation: The Soldier and willing allies within 30 feet of them can move through crowded or dangerous environments without interfering with one another. Allies do not obstruct each other's movement or lines of fire, and the group gains advantage on checks involving coordinated movement, tactical positioning, or organized retreats.

Tactical Genius: For -8 Authority, the Soldier can devise a comprehensive plan for a specific objective. The Soldier identifies up to five steps

required to accomplish that objective. For the next hour, all willing participants gain advantage on checks directly related to carrying out those steps, provided the plan remains reasonably applicable to the situation. Unexpected complications do not automatically invalidate the plan.

Level 10: At level 10, the following abilities are gained:

Total Mobilization: For -11 Authority, the Soldier grants each member of their party an extra turn, and the turns can be sequenced according to the soldier.

Level 11: At level 11, there is no longer a maximum Authority value.

Military Intelligence: For -10 Authority, the Soldier can deduce a significant weakness in an enemy organization, fortified location, or planned operation after studying available information for at least one minute. The GM reveals a meaningful vulnerability, overlooked

route, logistical problem, or tactical opportunity that the Soldier can exploit. The information must be accurate, although acting upon it may still be dangerous.

Level 12: At level 12, the amount of Authority added triples whenever Authority would be added.

Supreme Commander: For -15 Authority, the Soldier can issue a single extraordinary order to any number of willing creatures who can receive it. For the next 10 minutes, those creatures perform the ordered objective with nearly supernatural discipline and coordination. Participants gain advantage on all checks directly related to the objective, ignore ordinary fear and intimidation, and may act in coordinated sequences that would otherwise be impossible. The GM determines the limits of particularly extraordinary orders, but the ability cannot force unwilling creatures to obey or make physically impossible actions possible.

Prophet

The Prophet is a wandering sharpshooter of the nuclear wasteland, a holy warrior whose sacred scriptures are written in gunpowder and whose sermons are delivered at several thousand feet per second. Whether their faith comes from a surviving prewar religion, an apocalyptic cult, or a revelation received after drinking radioactive groundwater, the Prophet is absolutely convinced that a higher power guides their hand.

Prophets specialize in precision weapons, observation, religious influence, patience, and the elimination of enemies from extraordinary distances. They are equally comfortable delivering an impassioned sermon, identifying a sinner in a crowded settlement, or spending fourteen hours motionless on a rooftop waiting for divine permission to pull the trigger.

Prophets are all about Faith. Every fulfilled prophecy, successful shot, and demonstration of

religious conviction strengthens their certainty that the universe is on their side. The more Faith they accumulate, the more difficult it becomes to distinguish their marksmanship from genuine divine intervention.

It is recommended that Prophets focus stat points into Dex and Wis.

Enemies who make saving throws as a result of the Prophets abilities make those saves against the Prophet's wisdom

Primary Class Feature: Prophets gain access to "Faith" points. Prophets earn Faith through successful acts of perception, precision, and religious devotion, and spend those points to perform extraordinary feats.

Prophets earn a Faith point for any of the following, though dungeon masters can award extra points at will:

+1 For a successful Dexterity check or save

+1 For a successful Wisdom check or save

+1 For successfully identifying a hidden enemy, trap, or important detail through observation

+1 For landing an attack with a precision or scoped weapon

+1 For successfully persuading, inspiring, or intimidating another creature through religious conviction

+2 For eliminating a dangerous enemy with a single carefully aimed shot

As the character levels up, they increase their maximum Faith, as well as unlock new abilities with that Faith. Faith resets after a long rest.

Level 1: Level 1 Prophets gain access to the first two Faith abilities, and at level 1 have a max Faith of 3.

Divine Guidance: For -1 Faith, the Prophet can reroll any check. They must take the new value.

The Lord Provides: For -3 Faith, the Prophet can roll 3 dice instead of one for any check, and select which die they wish.

In addition, Prophets gain +1 to attack checks made with precision rifles and +1 to Wisdom checks involving observation or religious knowledge.

Level 2: At level 2, Prophets unlock the following:

Mark of the Heretic: For -2 Faith, the Prophet can declare a creature they can see to be a heretic. For the next 10 minutes, the Prophet always knows the target's approximate direction while it remains within 300 Feet, and gains advantage on their first attack against that target. Only one creature can be marked at a time.

Level 3: Max Faith increases from 3 to 5, and the Prophet gains the ability to interpret omens in ordinary events. After spending one minute examining an environment, the Prophet may ask the GM whether a particular course of action appears favorable, unfavorable, or uncertain. The GM must answer truthfully based on the information available, though the interpretation

may be cryptic. This ability may be used once per long rest without spending Faith.

Level 4: At level 4, the Prophet unlocks the following:

Blessed Ammunition: For -2 Faith, the Prophet can bless up to three rounds of ammunition. For the next hour, attacks made with those rounds ignore ordinary cover penalties and count as extraordinary or sanctified attacks against creatures resistant to conventional weaponry. Unused blessed ammunition loses its blessing after one hour.

Street Preacher: For -2 Faith, the Prophet can deliver an impassioned sermon to creatures capable of understanding them. After one minute of preaching, the Prophet gains advantage on Charisma checks involving persuasion, intimidation, or inspiring the audience for the next 10 minutes. Hostile audiences may resist through a Wisdom save.

Level 5: At level 5, max Faith increases to 7.

The Lord Works in Mysterious Ways: For -5 Faith, the Prophet can declare that an unlikely event is a sign of divine intervention. The GM introduces a plausible but highly fortunate coincidence that advances the Prophet's immediate objective. Examples include a guard abandoning their post, a locked door being left open, or an enemy's weapon unexpectedly malfunctioning. The coincidence cannot directly kill a creature or resolve a major plot objective by itself.

Level 6: At level 6, the Prophet unlocks the following:

Eye of Providence: The Prophet has advantage on Wisdom checks involving detecting concealed creatures, spotting distant details, recognizing deception, and identifying suspicious behavior. Additionally, the Prophet can accurately estimate distances to visible targets without special equipment.

Confession: For -4 Faith, the Prophet can confront a creature they can communicate with

and demand that it confess its sins. The target must make a Wisdom save. On a failure, it feels an overwhelming compulsion to truthfully reveal one significant wrongdoing, secret, or source of guilt. The target chooses which truth to reveal, and the Prophet cannot specify the information disclosed. A successful save makes the creature immune to this ability for 24 hours.

Level 7: At level 7, max Faith increases to 9, and the amount of Faith added doubles whenever Faith would be added.

Judgment Day: For -7 Faith, the Prophet may designate a creature they can see as the subject of divine judgment. For the next 3 turns, the Prophet's ranged attacks against that creature ignore ordinary cover penalties, have advantage, and deal double damage. The effect ends if the target dies or the duration expires.

Level 8: At level 8, the following effects are added:

Unshakable Conviction: The Prophet has advantage on saves against fear, intimidation, and attempts to undermine their beliefs. Additionally, the Prophet can remain perfectly still and alert for extraordinarily long periods without suffering ordinary discomfort or loss of concentration.

Pilgrimage: For -5 Faith, the Prophet may pray for guidance toward a specific person, object, or location that they have sufficient reason to believe exists. The GM provides a meaningful clue about where or how it might be found. This may take the form of a vision, an overheard conversation, an unexpected discovery, or an apparent coincidence. The ability does not guarantee that the destination is safe or accessible.

Level 9: At level 9, max Faith becomes 11.

The Gospel According to Ballistics: The Prophet no longer suffers ordinary penalties for attacking targets at extreme range, provided they can clearly see the target and their weapon

is physically capable of reaching it. Additionally, the Prophet may use reflective surfaces, shadows, and environmental clues to identify targets who are not directly visible.

Divine Retribution: For -8 Faith, when a creature the Prophet can see harms one of their allies, the Prophet may immediately make one ranged attack against that creature, even outside their normal turn. If the attack hits, it deals double damage. This ability cannot be used more than once per round.

Level 10: At level 10, the following ability is gained:

Thou Shalt Not Miss: For -11 Faith, the Prophet may declare a single ranged attack to be divinely ordained. If the target is within the physical range of the weapon and the Prophet has a plausible means of identifying its location, the attack automatically hits, regardless of ordinary cover, visibility, or accuracy penalties. The attack deals triple normal damage. Extraordinary defenses or major plot

protections may still apply at the GM's discretion.

Level 11: At level 11, there is no longer a maximum Faith value.

Prophet of the Wasteland: For -10 Faith, the Prophet can deliver a prophecy concerning a specific future event. The GM determines a plausible way in which the prophecy could become true and provides the Prophet with a cryptic revelation about the circumstances. For the next 24 hours, the Prophet and their allies gain advantage on checks directly related to bringing about or preventing that event. The prophecy cannot guarantee an impossible outcome.

Level 12: At level 12, the amount of Faith added triples whenever Faith would be added.

And God Said, Let There Be Lead: For -15 Faith, the Prophet may invoke divine judgment upon up to six creatures they can identify within the effective range of their weapon. The Prophet makes one ranged attack against each designated

creature, regardless of the weapon's normal firing rate or ammunition capacity. These attacks automatically hit and deal triple normal damage.

During the attack, the Prophet may describe an extraordinary religious manifestation: a blinding halo, a chorus of distant angels, a thunderous voice from the heavens, or some other unmistakable sign of divine wrath. Whether this manifestation is genuinely supernatural, an extraordinary coincidence, or a shared hallucination is left to the GM.

After the attack, the Prophet must spend their next turn reloading, praying, or otherwise recovering from the experience.

Weaponry and Armor

Ammunition and Reloading

Ordinary ammunition is not tracked in 501 Rads. Characters are assumed to carry sufficient ammunition for their conventional weapons, and reloading occurs automatically as part of normal weapon use.

Reloading does not consume an Action, Bonus Action, Skill Action, or Movement.

This rule applies to ordinary ballistic ammunition, energy cells, chemical cartridges, and other standard weapon consumables.

Heavy Explosive Ammunition: Particularly destructive weapons, including rocket launchers, missile launchers, and other heavy explosive

systems, require individually tracked ammunition. The Game Master determines which weapons fall into this category.

Unusual weapons may have additional ammunition requirements when explicitly stated in their descriptions.

Weapon Proficiencies

Weapons are divided into four proficiency categories:

Category	Included Weapons
Sidearms	Pistols, revolvers, compact energy weapons, and similar one-handed firearms
Long Guns	Rifles, shotguns, sniper rifles, SMGs, and similar firearms
Heavy Weapons	Machine guns, rocket launchers, heavy energy weapons, and other cumbersome armaments
Melee Weapons	Knives, clubs, swords, improvised melee weapons, and unarmed combat

Characters add their Proficiency Bonus to attack rolls made with weapons belonging to categories in which they are proficient.

Characters may use weapons outside their proficiencies, but do not add their Proficiency Bonus to those attacks.

Additional weapon proficiencies may be acquired through feats or class abilities.

Starting Weapon Proficiencies

Class	Starting Proficiencies
Gunslinger	Sidearms, Melee Weapons
Psycho	Melee Weapons
Hacker	Sidearms
Medic	Sidearms, Melee Weapons
Soldier	Sidearms, Long Guns, Heavy Weapons, Melee Weapons
Prophet	Long Guns, Melee Weapons

All characters can attempt to use any weapon, regardless of proficiency.

Weapon proficiencies represent training and familiarity rather than restrictions on equipment.

Weapon Special Properties

Special weapon properties are generally activated as part of the normal Attack Action and do not require additional actions unless explicitly stated.

Weapon properties and class abilities may be combined when their effects are compatible.

Exotic and unusual weapons may have additional rules governing their use, determined by their individual descriptions.

The Weapons of the Wasteland

Ballistic firearms

These are the workhorses of the wasteland. Most are recognizable firearms, but their quality ranges from plumbing accidents to precision military engineering.

Accuracy is the bonus or penalty added to the attack roll.

Weapon	Tier	Damage	Type	Range	Acc.
Pipe Popper Pistol	Pipe	1d6-2	Ballistic	40 ft	+1
Kitchen Sink Revolver	Pipe	1d8-2	Ballistic	30 ft	+0
Rustbucket SMG	Pipe	1d4-2	Ballistic	50 ft	+2

Scrapheap Rifle	Pipe	1d8-2	Ballistic	100 ft	+1
Boomstick Shotgun	Pipe	2d6-2	Ballistic	25 ft	+2
Rusty Hunting Rifle	Low	1d10-1	Ballistic	150 ft	-2
P-12 Civilian Pistol	Low	1d8-1	Ballistic	50 ft	+1
Six-Shooter Revolver	Low	1d10-1	Ballistic	40 ft	+0
Coachman's Double Barrel	Low	2d6-1	Ballistic	30 ft	+2
9mm Service Pistol	Mid	1d8	Ballistic	50 ft	+1
Rattler-9 SMG	Mid	1d6	Ballistic	60 ft	+2

ARK-92 Assault Rifle	Mid	1d10	Ballistic	120 ft	+1
Longhorn Hunting Rifle	Mid	2d8	Ballistic	250 ft	-2
M88 Combat Shotgun	Mid	2d6	Ballistic	30 ft	+2
M-14 Tactical Revolver	Military	1d10+2	Ballistic	40 ft	+0
ARK-110 Battle Rifle	Military	1d10+2	Ballistic	150 ft	+1
Viper-6 Compact SMG	Military	1d6+2	Ballistic	70 ft	+2
M101 Breacher Shotgun	Military	2d6+2	Ballistic	35 ft	+2
XR-50 Anti-Material Rifle	Military	2d8+2	Ballistic	300 ft	-2

Weapon-family properties

These apply to all weapons of the corresponding type, unless a weapon specifies otherwise.

Family	Property
Pistol	Quickdraw: Draw or holster once per turn without an action
Revolver	Big Iron: Critical hits roll one additional weapon damage die
SMG	Spray: Attack two targets within 10 ft of one another; distribute the damage rolled across the two targets. Must assign some damage to all targets.
Rifle	Sustained Fire: Attacking a target you attacked last turn grants +2 Acc.

Shotgun	Point Blank: +2 damage within 10 ft
Sniper rifle	Aimed Shot: If you haven't moved this turn, ignore the sniper's accuracy penalty

Energy, radiation, and experimental firearms

Energy weapons aren't simply upgraded ballistics. They have their own interactions with the environment and enemies.

Weapon	Tier	Damage	Type	Range	Acc.
Jury-Rigged Laser Pistol	Pipe	1d6-2	Energy	40 ft	+1

DynamoCo Civilian Laser Pistol	Low	1d8-1	Energy	60 ft	+1
Rothberg Security Stunner	Low	1d6-1	Electrical	30 ft	+1
DynamoCo L-40 Laser Rifle	Mid	1d10	Energy	130 ft	+1
Rad-Rat Irradiator Pistol	Mid	1d8	Radiation	40 ft	+1
Nutrocorp Chemical Sprayer	Mid	2d6	Chemical	20 ft	+2

DynamoCo P-80 Plasma Pistol	Mid	1d10	Fire	45 ft	+0
Rothberg Arc Rifle	Military	1d10+2	Electrical	100 ft	+1
DynamoCo L-99 Precision Laser	Military	2d8+2	Energy	250 ft	-2
P-91 Plasma Carbine	Military	2d6+2	Fire	80 ft	+1
RAD-44 Gamma Projector	Military	2d8+2	Radiation	80 ft	-1
Rothberg Ion Disruptor	Exotic	2d8	Electrical	90 ft	+0

Special interactions: Laser weapons can ignite flammable materials; plasma weapons can melt or burn obstacles; electrical weapons can disrupt exposed electronics; chemical weapons can disperse their contents over surfaces; radiation weapons can contaminate areas or interact with radiation-sensitive creatures.

These interactions are subject to GM judgment, not automatic additional damage or mutations.

Melee weapons

Weapon	Tier	Damage	Type	Reach	Acc.	Special
Broken Bottle	Pipe	1d4-2	Piercing	5 ft	+1	Concealable
Rusty Stop Sign	Pipe	2d6-2	Bludgeoning	5 ft	-1	Can serve as improvised cover
Rebar Shiv	Pipe	1d6-2	Piercing	5 ft	+1	Concealable

Brick on a Stick	Pipe	2d6-2	Bludgeoning	5 ft	-1	Can smash fragile obstacles
Gravedigger's Shovel	Low	2d6-1	Bludgeoning	5 ft	-1	+2 damage against prone targets
Rusted Fire Axe	Low	2d6-1	Slashing	5 ft	-1	Effective against wooden barriers
Tire Iron	Low	1d6-1	Bludgeoning	5 ft	+1	Useful for prying
Butcher's Cleaver	Low	1d6-1	Slashing	5 ft	+1	Concealable

Combat Knife	Mid	1d6	Piercing	5 ft	+1	Finesse, concealable
Fireman's Halligan	Mid	2d6	Bludgeoning	5 ft	-1	Advantage on appropriate forced-entry checks
Security Baton	Mid	1d6	Bludgeoning	5 ft	+1	Can deal nonlethal damage
Industrial Chainsaw	Mid	2d6	Slashing	5 ft	-1	+2 damage against unarmored targets
M-12 Combat Machete	Military	1d6+2	Slashing	5 ft	+1	Finesse

M-44 Breaching Hammer	Military	2d6+2	Bludgeoning	5 ft	-1	Double damage against ordinary doors
Military-Grade Chainsaw	Military	2d6+2	Slashing	5 ft	-1	+2 damage against unarmored targets
Rothberg Shock Baton	Military	1d6+2	Electrical	5 ft	+1	Can disrupt exposed electronics
Irradiated Cattle Prod	Exotic	1d8	Radiation	5 ft	+1	Can contaminate a struck object
Pneumatic Jackhammer	Exotic	2d8	Bludgeoning	5 ft	-2	Ignores 2 points of

						object damage reduction

Light melee weapons have +1 accuracy and are generally concealable. Heavy melee weapons have -1 accuracy and knock targets prone on a critical hit, unless otherwise specified. Unarmed strikes deal 1d4 bludgeoning damage at +0 accuracy.

Heavy weapons and explosives

Weapons in this category that cause blast damage or otherwise massive destruction must track ammo.

Weapon	Tier	Damage	Type	Range	Acc.	Special
Scrap Cannon	Pipe	2d8-2	Ballistic	50 ft	-2	Loud and cumbersome

Junkyard Grenade Tube	Pipe	2d6-2	Blast	60 ft	-2	10-ft radius; tracked shells
M60 Heavy Machine Gun	Mid	2d10	Ballistic	100 ft	-2	Braced
M79 Grenade Launcher	Mid	3d6	Blast	100 ft	-1	10-ft radius; tracked shells
M72 Rocket Launcher	Mid	4d8	Blast	180 ft	-2	15-ft radius; tracked rockets
M134 Rotary Cannon	Military	2d10+2	Ballistic	120 ft	-2	Braced

Rothberg Plasma Cannon	Military	3d8+2	Energy	100 ft	-2	10-ft radius
M202 Incendiary Launcher	Military	3d8+2	Fire	100 ft	-1	15-ft radius; tracked rockets
M99 Anti-Armor Missile System	Military	5d8+2	Blast	250 ft	-2	10-ft radius; tracked missiles
DynamoCo Portable Particle Accelerator	Exotic	4d10	Energy	150 ft	-2	Penetrates ordinary cover

Braced: If the wielder moved during their turn, the weapon takes an additional -2 accuracy penalty.

Explosive Scattering

For explosive area attacks, or any other attack that affects a wide area, the attack roll determines whether the projectile lands at the intended point. The default DC of an area attack is 13, but can be modified by DM discretion based on environmental factors. If the check succeeds, then things go fine. If the result failed by 3 or less, the impact is 5 feet away from target. For each step of 3 by which it failed, 5 more feet are added to the miss.

Check Failed By	Scatter distance
1-3	5 ft
4-6	10 ft
7-9	15 ft

10-12	20 ft

The DM is free to choose the direction of the miss. Creatures in the radius then make a DEX saving throw for half damage. If a miss causes unintended targets to be in the area, they are very much in danger.

The saving throw DC is 8 + the thrower's Dexterity modifier + Proficiency Bonus (if proficient). This is identical to Thrown Weapon attacks that deal area damage as defined in the throwable weapons section.

Throwable Weapons

Throwables are single-use weapons that are consumed when thrown. Unlike ordinary firearm ammunition, each throwable must be individually tracked.

All characters proficient with Sidearms are proficient with throwable weapons.

Throwables use Dexterity for attack rolls and damage modifiers, where applicable.

Throwing: Using a throwable requires an Action. The character selects a target creature or point within the throwable's listed range.

Direct Hits: Throwables without a blast radius use ordinary ranged attack rules against the target's AC.

Area Effects: Throwables with a blast radius use the normal explosive scatter rules. (see above section) The target location has a base placement DC of 13, which the Game Master may adjust for difficult circumstances.

Every creature within the final blast radius makes a Dexterity saving throw. On a failure, the creature takes full listed damage; on a success, half damage, rounded down. Additional conditions or effects are resolved as specified by the throwable.

The saving throw DC is 8 + the thrower's Dexterity modifier + Proficiency Bonus (if

proficient). This is identical to AOE attacks as defined in the explosive scattering section.

Persistent Effects: Smoke, fire, gas, and radiation clouds last for their listed duration. Creatures entering or beginning their turns inside a damaging persistent area are affected as described by the item. Unless explicitly stated, the initial explosion damage is not repeated on subsequent turns.

Consumables: A thrown item is expended regardless of whether the attack succeeds or misses.

Throwable	Tier	Damage	Type	Range	Radius	Special
Bottle Bomb	Pipe	1d6	Blast	40 ft	5 ft	Improvised explosive; exceptionally loud
Molotov Cocktail	Pipe	1d6	Fire	40 ft	10 ft	Ignites flammable surfaces; fire persists for 2 rounds

Brick of Justice	Pipe	1d6	Bludgeoning	50 ft	Direct	Can break windows and fragile objects
Rustbucket Smoke Bomb	Low	–	–	50 ft	15 ft	Creates dense smoke for 3 rounds, obscuring vision
Flashbang Grenade	Low	1d4	Blast	60 ft	15 ft	CON save or blinded until end of next turn
Nutrocorp Gas Grenade	Mid	2d6	Chemical	60 ft	10 ft	CON save or poisoned for 2 rounds
M67 Fragmentation Grenade	Mid	3d6	Blast	60 ft	15 ft	Standard military fragmentation explosive

Rothberg Shock Grenade	Mid	2d6	Electrical	60 ft	10 ft	Electronic devices may be disabled for 1 round
M88 Incendiary Grenade	Military	3d6	Fire	60 ft	15 ft	Creates burning terrain for 3 rounds
M92 High-Explosive Grenade	Military	4d6	Blast	60 ft	15 ft	Particularly destructive to objects and cover
RAD-9 Dirty Bomb	Military	2d8	Radiation	60 ft	20 ft	Contaminates the area for 1 minute
DynamoCo Singularity Grenade	Exotic	3d8	Energy	60 ft	15 ft	STR save or pulled 10 ft toward the explosion's center

The 15 legendary weapons of the Wasteland

Weapon	Family	Damage	Type	Range	Acc.	Unique property
The Tax Collector – Coin Rifle	Rifle	1d10	Ballistic	100 ft	+1	Fires coins. Spend $10 in ammunition to add +1 damage, up to +5 per attack
The Geneva Suggestion – Chemical Launcher	Heavy	2d6	Chemical	60 ft	-1	On hit, target makes a CON save or suffers a random effect: blinded, poisoned, or incapacitated until the end of its next turn
The Divorce Attorney – Double-Barrel Shotgun	Shotgun	2d6	Ballistic	30 ft	+2	When attacking a creature adjacent to another, deal 1d6 damage

						to the second creature on a hit
The Final Notice - Revolver	Revolver	1d10	Ballistic	40 ft	+0	On each attack, roll 1d6. On a 6, double the weapon's damage dice
The People's Elbow - Pneumatic Fist	Melee	2d8	Bludgeoning	5 ft	-1	On hit, target makes STR save or is pushed 15 ft
The Microwave - Thermal Projector	Long Gun	1d8	Fire	50 ft	+0	Armored targets take an additional 1d6 fire damage at the start of their next turn
The Second Amendment - Multi-Barrel Gun	Heavy	4d6	Ballistic	40 ft	-2	Fires every barrel simultaneously; cannot attack with it on consecutive turns

The Roach Motel – Pheromone Launcher	Long Gun	1d6	Chemical	60 ft	+1	Marks a target for 3 turns; nearby mutant insects are attracted to it
The Eviction Notice – Industrial Shotgun	Shotgun	2d8	Ballistic	30 ft	+1	On hit, target makes STR save or is pushed 10 ft; can destroy flimsy cover
The HR Department – Compliance Taser	Sidearm	1d6	Electrical	30 ft	+1	Target makes WIS save or obeys one harmless, one-sentence instruction
The Stimulus Package – Currency Grenade Launcher	Heavy	3d6	Blast	80 ft	-1	10-ft radius; scatters 5–25 in recoverable currency per shot; tracked grenades

The Organ Donor – Surgical Harpoon	Long Gun	2d6	Piercing	60 ft	+0	On hit, pull a Large or smaller target 15 ft toward you unless it succeeds on a STR save
The Family Reunion – Cluster Launcher	Heavy	3d8	Blast	100 ft	-2	On impact, affects three 5-ft-radius areas within 20 ft of the impact point; tracked shells
The Holy Handgun – Sermon Pistol	Sidearm	1d8	Ballistic	50 ft	+1	Deliver a dramatic sermon as part of the attack to gain +1 accuracy; once per turn
The Warranty Voider – EMP Rifle	Long Gun	2d6	Electrical	100 ft	+1	Deals +1d8 damage to robots and electronic equipment; electronic targets also lose reactions until their

						next turn on a failed CON save

Consumables, Drugs, Medicines

Consumables are single-use items that are expended when used. Each consumable must be individually tracked.

Administration: Using a consumable on yourself requires a Bonus Action. Administering one to another willing or Incapacitated creature within 5 ft requires an Action. An unwilling creature must first be restrained or otherwise rendered unable to resist.

Duration: Effects last for their listed duration. Unless specified otherwise, a temporary effect lasting a number of turns expires at the end of the affected creature's final turn.

Stacking: Multiple doses of the same consumable do not stack their benefits. Taking another dose refreshes its duration, but does not eliminate any drawbacks already incurred. Different consumables follow the normal effect-stacking rules.

Drug Drawbacks: Any negative effects listed after a drug's beneficial duration occur when that duration ends, even if the user takes another dose.

Healing: Consumables cannot restore HP to dead creatures unless explicitly stated. A creature reduced to 0 HP follows the normal Mutation Revival rules.

Radiation: Temporary radioactive effects may be removed by appropriate medicines. Permanent positive and negative mutations are unaffected unless an item explicitly states otherwise.

Mutation Granting Drugs: Drugs which grant a temporary mutation do not preclude a character from potentially receiving that mutation

permanently in the future. Mutation granting drugs, like all mutations, cannot grant a duplicate mutation.

Consumable	Tier	Effect
Dirty Bandages	Pipe	Restore 1d4 HP.
First Aid Kit	Low	Restore 1d6+2 HP.
Nutrocorp Stimpak	Mid	Restore 2d6+2 HP.
Military Trauma Injector	Military	Restore 4d6+4 HP.
RadAway	Mid	Removes temporary radiation-related conditions and contamination, but not permanent mutations.
Antidote	Low	Ends the Poisoned condition and neutralizes one ordinary poison.
Burn Gel	Low	Ends the Burning condition and restores 1d4 HP.
Adrenaline Shot	Mid	Immediately ends the Stunned condition.

Surgical Foam	Military	Restore 2d8 HP and end one ordinary bleeding or wound-related effect.
Nutrocorp Miracle Cure	Exotic	Restore all HP and end Poisoned, Burning, and temporary radiation effects. Roll once on the radioactive side-effect table.
Rajin	Low	"+2 melee damage for 3 turns. Afterward, suffer disadvantage on Intelligence checks for 10 minutes."
BulletTime	Mid	Gain +10 ft movement speed and +2 Initiative for 3 turns. Afterward, movement speed is reduced by 10 ft for 2 turns.
Buffout	Mid	Gain +2 to Strength checks and Strength saving throws for 10 minutes. Afterward, suffer disadvantage on Dexterity checks for 10 minutes.
Med-X	Mid	Reduce incoming damage by 2 for 3 turns, minimum 0. Afterward, suffer disadvantage on Perception checks for 10 minutes.
Overdrive	Military	Gain +2 accuracy and +2 damage with weapon attacks for 3 turns. Afterward, suffer 2d6 damage.

Berserker Serum	Military	Double melee weapon damage for 2 turns. During this time, you cannot willingly retreat from an enemy you can see. Afterward, become Stunned until the end of your next turn.
Nutrocorp Experimental Stimulant	Exotic	Gain one additional Action on your next turn. Immediately roll twice on the radioactive side-effect table and apply both results.
Canned Mystery Meat	Low	During a short rest, restore an additional 1d4 HP. If taken during a long rest, gain 4 temporary bonus hp.
Purified Water	Low	Removes ordinary dehydration and grants advantage on the next CON save against heat or exhaustion within 1 hour.
Military Ration Pack	Mid	Sustains one person for a full day and grants +1 to their next Survival check within that day.
Caffeine Tablets	Low	Ignore ordinary fatigue-related penalties for 1 hour. Afterward, suffer disadvantage on the next CON check made to resist fatigue.

Anti-Rad Tablets	Mid	Gain resistance to radiation damage for 3 turns.
Glow Juice	Pipe	Glow brightly for 10 minutes. Gain advantage on Intimidation checks against ordinary wastelanders, but disadvantage on Stealth checks.
Mutagen Cocktail	Military	Roll once on the positive mutation table and gain that mutation for 10 minutes. Afterward, roll once on the radioactive side-effect table.
Nutrocorp Rejuvenation Serum	Exotic	Restore 3d8 HP and gain +10 ft movement speed for 3 turns. Afterward, suffer 1d8 radiation damage.
Nutrocorp Genesis Serum	Exotic	Permanently gain one randomly rolled positive mutation. Reroll duplicates. Extremely rare and prohibitively expensive; typically obtainable only through major quests, black-market auctions, or high-level corporate facilities.

Currency

There are three currencies recognized in the wasteland;

Dollar ($)

Chip (¢)

Fusion Cell (FC)

While vendors accept all three, the most common and de facto currency of the wasteland is Chips. Chips are small pieces of burnt out pre-war circuitry. Because the factories that produce them have been destroyed, no one can forge new ones, so people know chips are legit.

Some people still use the pre-war dollar, but there are so many in circulation, they are very invaluable. 100 pre-war dollars is equivalent to one chip.

The fusion cell is the highest tier of currency. Unlike the other two, fusion cells can be used

to power generators and vehicles, making them sought after as more than just a currency. Generally, fusion cells are worth 100 chips, and for large transactions are used as a bulk currency.

Exchange rates:

- 100 pre-war dollars = 1 chip
- 100 chips = 1 fusion cell
- 10,000 pre-war dollars = 1 fusion cell

All prices will be expressed in chips by default. Conversions can be done by the player.

Price Reference

Prices, ultimately, are up to the DM. As a vague reference, here are a bunch of common items and their usual prices.

Item or Service	Typical Price (Chips)
Cheap meal	1

Dirty water	1
Purified water	2
Basic lodging (one night)	2-3
Dirty Bandages	2
First Aid Kit	4
Nutrocorp Stimpak	8
Standard combat drug	10-20
Military-grade medicine	25-50
Exotic medicine	100-500
Pipe-tier weapon	5-15
Low-tier weapon	20-40
Mid-tier weapon	60-120
Military-tier weapon	200-500
Exotic-tier weapon	1,000+
Pipe-tier throwable	2-5
Low-tier throwable	5-10

Mid-tier throwable	15–30
Military-tier throwable	40–100
Light armor	15
Medium armor	60
Heavy armor	250
Powered armor	1,500+
Basic mechanical repairs	5–20
Professional medical treatment	10–50
Surgical mutation removal	200–1,000
Local transportation	2–10
Long-distance transportation	20–100
Heavy explosive ammunition	20–100 per round
Nutrocorp Genesis Serum	10,000+

Loot

Players should, of course, be awarded for their efforts. Below are suggested loot tables for various player levels and circumstances. If an engagement was particularly easy, consider a grade below player level as a reward. If it was very challenging, consider a grade above.

Players start with 2d4 * 10 chips, and any one pipe weapon which their starting class is proficient in. The psycho and soldier may choose to start with light armor instead of their starting chips.

Grade 1 Cache - Best for Level 1 and 2 players

d20	Loot
1-2	Empty container. Someone got here first.
3-4	1d4 Dirty Bandages.

5-6	1d4 Canned Mystery Meat and 1d4 Purified Water.
7-8	1d4 First Aid Kits.
9-10	One random Pipe-tier weapon.
11-12	One random Low-tier consumable.
13-14	1d4 Pipe-tier throwables.
15-16	One random Low-tier weapon.
17-18	Roll once on the Valuables Table.
19	One random Low-tier weapon and 1d4 First Aid Kits.
20	One random Mid-tier consumable and roll once on the Valuables Table.

Grade 2 Cache - Best for Level 3 and 4 players

d20	Loot
1-2	1d4 First Aid Kits and 1d4 Purified Water.
3-4	1d4 Nutrocorp Stimpaks.
5-6	One random Low-tier weapon.
7-8	One random Mid-tier combat drug.
9-10	1d4 Low-tier throwables.
11-12	Roll once on the Valuables Table.
13-14	One random Mid-tier weapon.
15-16	One random Mid-tier weapon and 1d4 Stimpaks.
17-18	One set of Light armor and one Low-tier weapon.
19	One random Mid-tier throwable and roll once on the Valuables Table.

20	One random Military-tier consumable.

Grade 3 Cache - Best for Level 5 and 6 players

d20	Loot
1-2	2d4 Nutrocorp Stimpaks.
3-4	One random Mid-tier weapon.
5-6	One set of Medium armor.
7-8	2d4 Mid-tier combat drugs.
9-10	1d4 Mid-tier throwables.
11-12	Roll twice on the Valuables Table.
13-14	One random Military-tier consumable.
15-16	One random Mid-tier weapon and 2d4 Stimpaks.

17-18	One random Military-tier weapon.
19	One random Military-tier weapon and one Military-tier consumable.
20	One random Exotic-tier consumable.

Grade 4 Cache - Best for Level 7 and 8 players

d20	Loot
1-2	2d4 Military Trauma Injectors.
3-4	One random Military-tier weapon.
5-6	One set of Heavy armor.
7-8	2d4 Military-tier combat drugs.
9-10	1d4 Military-tier throwables.

11-12	Roll twice on the Valuables Table.
13-14	Two random Military-tier weapons.
15-16	One random Exotic-tier consumable.
17-18	One Military-tier weapon and one set of Heavy armor.
19	One random Exotic-tier weapon.
20	One random Exotic-tier weapon and roll twice on the Valuables Table.

Grade 5 Cache - Best for Level 9 and 10 players

d20	Loot

1-2	2d4 Military Trauma Injectors and 2d4 Military-tier combat drugs.
3-4	Two random Military-tier weapons.
5-6	One random Exotic-tier consumable.
7-8	One set of Heavy armor and one Military-tier weapon.
9-10	2d4 Military-tier throwables and 1d4 Exotic-tier consumables.
11-12	Roll three times on the Valuables Table.
13-14	One random Exotic-tier weapon.
15-16	One random Exotic-tier weapon and 2d4 Military Trauma Injectors.

17-18	One set of Powered armor.
19	Two random Exotic-tier weapons.
20	One Nutrocorp Genesis Serum.

Grade 6 Cache - Best for Level 11 and 12 players

d20	Loot
1-2	4d4 Military Trauma Injectors and 2d4 Exotic-tier consumables.
3-4	Two random Exotic-tier weapons.
5-6	One set of Powered armor.
7-8	Three random Military-tier weapons and 2d4 Military-tier throwables.

9-10	Roll four times on the Valuables Table.
11-12	One random Exotic-tier weapon and one set of Powered armor.
13-14	Three random Exotic-tier consumables.
15-16	Two random Exotic-tier weapons and 2d4 Military Trauma Injectors.
17-18	One Nutrocorp Genesis Serum.
19	One Nutrocorp Genesis Serum and one random Exotic-tier weapon.
20	Two Nutrocorp Genesis Serums and roll four times on the Valuables Table.

General Valuables Table - Roll to generate an amount of currency in a cache. Can either be a supplement to a cache, or the cache itself.

d20	Valuables	Total value in chips
1-3	A handful of pre-war dollars	1 X Container Grade
4-5	Loose chips and scrap currency	2 X Container Grade
6-7	A sealed envelope of pre-war money	4 X Container Grade
8-9	Old-world jewelry and personal effects	8 X Container Grade
10-11	A small stash of chips	12 X Container Grade

12-13	Valuable electronic components	20 X Container Grade
14-15	A collection of rare pre-war artifacts	30 X Container Grade
16-17	A locked cashbox containing chips	50 X Container Grade
18-19	A hidden reserve of fusion cells and chips	75 X Container Grade
20	A pre-war corporate emergency fund	150 X Container Grade

Vehicles

The wasteland is big and hard to get around. Vehicles, while rare to find in working condition, can make the process easier. The following is a list of common vehicle archetypes on might see in the wasteland.

Vehicle	Fuel	Tank Capacity	Range	Max Speed	Passengers	Typical Price (Chips)
Rusty Bicycle	None	–	Unlimited	15	1	15
Scrap Motorcycle	Gasoline	3 gal	90	70	2	100
Wasteland Buggy	Gasoline	10 gal	180	65	2	250
Pre-War Sedan	Gasoline	15 gal	300	90	5	400
Junkie Crew Van	Diesel	20 gal	300	65	8	500
Armored Pickup	Diesel	25 gal	250	75	5	800

Caravan Hauler	Diesel	60 gal	420	55	3	1,200
Nutrocorp Executive Car	Fusion	2 cells	600	110	4	2,500
Patriot Armored Personnel Carrier	Diesel	100 gal	300	55	12	4,000
DynamoCo Fusion Truck	Fusion	5 cells	1,000	75	6	6,000
Pre-War Military Tank	Diesel	150 gal	150	40	4	12,000
Experimental Fusion Hovercraft	Fusion	8 cells	1,600	130	6	20,000

Vehicles require fuel to function. Approximate fuel prices below

Fuel	Typical Price	Notes
Gasoline	2 chips/gallon	Scarce outside established settlements

Diesel	1 chip/gallon	Common around industrial ruins and caravan routes
Fusion Cell	100 chips/cell	Also functions as high-value currency

Enemies

The previous lore section established common enemies and their lore. This segment provides reference to power level and grade of certain enemies

Like with the loot tables, enemies are sorted into a grade, 1-6, where grade 1 enemies are on the same approximate level as level 1-2 players, and so forth.

Grade	Enemy	HP	AC	Movement	Attack Modifier	Damage
1	Starving Raider	8	8	30 ft	+2	1d6+1
1	Feral Rad-Rat	6	9	40 ft	+3	1d4+2

1	Rustbucket Security Bot	12	10	20 ft	+2	1d6+1
1	Junkie Crew Grunt	10	9	35 ft	+3	1d6+2
2	Junkie Crew Enforcer	24	11	30 ft	+4	1d8+2
2	Irradiated Coyote	18	12	45 ft	+5	1d8+2
2	Patriot Militia Rifleman	20	11	30 ft	+5	1d10+2
2	Salvage Yard Automaton	28	12	20 ft	+4	1d10+2
3	Mutant Brute	45	12	35 ft	+6	2d8+3
3	Rothberg Security Trooper	35	14	30 ft	+6	1d10+4
3	Feral Rad-Bear	55	12	40 ft	+7	2d8+4
3	Tech Cult Combat Drone	30	15	40 ft	+7	2d6+3
4	Patriot Heavy Gunner	75	15	25 ft	+8	2d10+4

4	Nutrocorp Experimental Mutant	90	13	40 ft	+8	2d8+5
4	Pre-War Combat Robot	85	16	30 ft	+8	2d10+4
4	Radioman Exterminator	65	16	35 ft	+9	2d8+5
5	DynamoCo Assault Mech	140	17	30 ft	+10	3d10+5
5	Alpha Rad-Beast	165	15	45 ft	+11	3d8+6
5	Patriot Power-Armor Commander	125	18	30 ft	+11	3d10+5
5	Tech Cult War Machine	150	17	25 ft	+10	3d10+6
6	Pre-War Siege Automaton	250	19	25 ft	+12	4d10+7
6	Apex Nuclear Abomination	300	17	45 ft	+13	4d12+7
6	DynamoCo Experimental Warbot	225	20	35 ft	+13	4d10+8
6	The Glowing Patriarch	275	18	35 ft	+14	4d12+8

This list is not comprehensive, it represents a list of reference powers for enemies. Combining enemies makes them exponentially more difficult to deal with. At higher levels, consider a grade 6 boss and some grade 2-3 henchmen. DMs reserve the right to adjust freely.

Mutations

Mutations are a core (and wacky) part of the wasteland. For years now radioactive particles have been turning fish green and causing elk to grow seven heads. It just might happen to you!

Positive mutations occur when players make smart, lore building decisions, accomplish major milestones, or purchase treatments at rad doctors.

Negative mutations occur in place of death: If a character death would occur, the player receives

a negative mutation as their irradiated body stitches itself back together.

THE GOOD NEWS!

Not all mutations are bad! Some are actually surprisingly helpful…

Congratulations, wastelander! Your body has decided to improve itself without consulting you, your doctor, or the laws of nature! The following mutations have been observed to produce generally beneficial results. Side effects, unfortunate appearances, and the occasional medical mystery are entirely normal.

01. A Face for Radio

Your vocal cords have developed an extraordinary range. You can perfectly imitate any voice you have heard for at least one minute, including its accent and mannerisms. Unfortunately, this does not grant you knowledge of what that person would actually say.

02. The Human Compass

You always know which direction is north, even underground, underwater, or while unconscious. If someone spins you around while you're sleeping, you'll wake up furious and facing north.

03. A Gut Feeling

Your stomach has developed a rudimentary sense of danger. It growls loudly whenever someone nearby is deliberately lying to you. It cannot distinguish between a harmless lie and an important one, and does not tell you who is lying.

04. The Third Nostril

A fully functional nostril has appeared somewhere inconvenient on your body. It can detect radioactive substances through thin barriers, and you can reliably distinguish different sources of radiation by smell. Nobody knows why uranium smells like cinnamon.

05. The People's Elbow

Your elbows have become capable of bending in any direction without injury. You can contort your arms into remarkably small spaces, reach awkward mechanisms, and escape ordinary restraints. Your handshake is profoundly unsettling.

06. Unreasonable Charisma

Small domesticated animals find you irresistibly charming. Cats, dogs, chickens, and similar creatures will generally approach you peacefully and may follow simple instructions. This does not extend to humans, despite your insistence otherwise.

07. The Human Tape Recorder

You can perfectly recall and reproduce any sound you have heard within the past seven days. Conversations, passwords spoken aloud, melodies, and mechanical noises are all fair game. Your memory for visual information remains completely ordinary.

08. Photosynthesis, Sort Of

Your skin can extract a modest amount of nourishment from sunlight. A full day outdoors provides enough energy to replace one ordinary meal. You also become slightly greener after prolonged exposure, which is apparently unrelated.

09. The World's Greatest Poker Face

Your facial muscles have become entirely voluntary. You can suppress all involuntary facial expressions and convincingly imitate nearly any emotion. Your face does not betray fear, pain, surprise, or deception unless you want it to.

10. Pocket Dimension?

A small cavity has developed beneath the skin of your abdomen. It can safely store an object about the size of a grapefruit without discomfort. Objects stored inside do not decay any faster than normal. Please do not put anything sharp in there.

11. The Living Antenna

Your nervous system can receive ordinary radio transmissions without equipment. You can mentally tune to different frequencies, provided the signal is strong enough. You cannot transmit, but you can listen without anyone knowing.

12. A Very Thick Skull

Your skull has become extraordinarily dense. You are highly resistant to head injuries and can safely headbutt fragile barriers. Unfortunately, your head is noticeably heavier, which makes sleeping on cheap pillows difficult.

13. The Gift of Gab

You can understand the emotional intent of speech in any human language, even one you have never heard. You cannot understand the actual words, but can distinguish

threats, affection, sarcasm, fear, and sincerity with remarkable accuracy.

14. The Backup Set

Whenever you lose a tooth, a new one grows in within twenty-four hours. Your teeth can also gradually replace damaged fillings and repair minor fractures. Dentists hate this one simple trick.

15. The Long Arm of the Law

Your arms can stretch to approximately twice their normal length without injury. They retain their usual strength and dexterity, allowing you to retrieve distant objects, reach through gaps, or deliver a truly spectacular handshake.

16. Unnatural Luck

Once per session, when a purely coincidental event could plausibly help you, you may ask the GM whether that coincidence happens. The GM decides its exact form. Lost keys, convenient strangers, and improbable timing are fair game; miracles are not.

17. The Universal Blood Donor

Your blood is biologically compatible with every human blood type and can temporarily stabilize many common

illnesses when used in a transfusion. Your body replenishes donated blood unusually quickly. Medical professionals will be very interested in you.

18. The Human Lie Detector

You can hear subtle changes in another person's heartbeat when standing close to them. This allows you to recognize fear, excitement, and unusual stress, but not necessarily dishonesty. You are also exceptionally good at finding people hiding behind thin walls.

19. The Second Brain

A small auxiliary brain has developed somewhere inside your torso. You can consciously focus on two unrelated mental tasks at once, such as reading while maintaining a conversation, or monitoring two separate information feeds. Both tasks receive your full attention.

20. The Last Laugh

Your body has developed an extraordinary capacity for surviving otherwise fatal injuries. Once per session, when you would die from an injury that leaves recoverable remains, you instead survive in a critically wounded state. This does not prevent other consequences of the injury.

21. The Human Shovel

Your fingernails have hardened into extraordinarily durable digging implements. You can excavate ordinary soil almost as quickly as someone using a shovel, and can scrape through soft stone given enough time. Your hands remain perfectly capable of delicate work.

22. Familiar Faces

Your brain has become exceptionally good at recognizing faces. You never forget a face you have clearly seen, even decades later or after significant changes in appearance. Disguises that rely only on clothing or hairstyles are ineffective against you.

23. The Perfect Palate

Your tongue can identify individual ingredients in anything you taste, including trace quantities of drugs, poisons, and contaminants. You cannot identify substances you have never encountered, but can remember and recognize their flavors indefinitely.

24. Sticky Fingers

Your fingertips produce a harmless adhesive secretion. You can cling to walls and ceilings capable of supporting your weight, climb smooth surfaces, and hold small objects without gripping them. The secretion leaves no visible residue.

25. The Human Thermos

Your digestive system can store consumed liquids at their original temperature for up to twelve hours. You can voluntarily regurgitate them without discomfort or contamination. You can carry approximately two liters this way. An absolutely disgusting way to serve coffee.

26. The Skeleton Key

Your fingertips contain unusually sensitive nerves capable of detecting the internal movement of mechanical locks. When using improvised lockpicking tools, you can feel the positions of pins and tumblers as though you were looking directly at them.

27. The Nose Knows

Your sense of smell has become sophisticated enough to recognize individual humans by scent. You can follow a fresh scent trail under reasonable conditions and recognize someone even when their appearance or voice has changed.

28. The Human Bubble Level

Your inner ear has developed a perfect sense of orientation. You always know whether a surface is level, can accurately estimate slopes, and rarely lose

your balance. Ordinary dizziness and motion sickness no longer affect you.

29. Bone China

Your bones have become remarkably flexible without sacrificing strength. You can squeeze through openings barely wider than your skull, provided your internal organs can fit. Your body returns to its original shape afterward.

30. The Walking Library

Your brain perfectly retains anything you have read, although you cannot necessarily understand it. You can reproduce written passages from memory, including diagrams and unfamiliar symbols. You still have to actually read the material first.

31. Rainmaker

Your sweat glands have developed the ability to extract moisture directly from humid air. In sufficiently humid environments, you can collect a small but useful quantity of clean drinking water from your skin over several hours.

32. The Human Photocopier

Your skin can temporarily reproduce patterns placed against it. Pressing your hand against writing, fingerprints, or a textured surface creates a detailed impression that remains visible for approximately one hour. Particularly useful for copying keys, documents, and embarrassing tattoos.

33. Cold-Blooded Capitalist

Your body can enter a low-energy state in which your metabolism slows dramatically. While resting, you require very little food, water, or oxygen and can survive extreme cold far better than ordinary humans. You remain conscious but move very slowly.

34. The World's Smallest Orchestra

Your vocal anatomy can produce several independent tones simultaneously. You can imitate simple musical instruments, generate convincing mechanical noises, and perform harmonies entirely by yourself. This is technically impressive and extremely annoying.

35. Four Eyes Are Better Than Two

A second pair of eyes has developed beneath your original pair. These eyes can independently focus on nearby objects, allowing you to examine tiny details

while maintaining normal vision. You can also read two separate pages simultaneously.

36. The Human Seismograph

Your feet can detect subtle vibrations traveling through solid ground. You can sense approaching vehicles, large creatures, and nearby digging activity before they become audible. Soft ground and thick footwear reduce the effect.

37. A Heart of Gold

Your body has developed an extraordinary resistance to common poisons, recreational drugs, and chemical contaminants. Most substances that would intoxicate or poison an ordinary human have little effect on you. This also makes getting drunk rather difficult.

38. The Human Inkjet

Specialized glands beneath your fingernails produce a dark, permanent pigment. You can write or draw directly with your fingertips on most surfaces. The pigment is waterproof once dry and can be produced in several colors.

39. The Whispering Ear

Your ears can independently rotate and focus on specific directions. You can isolate quiet conversations from background noise, detect subtle mechanical sounds, and determine the direction of a noise with remarkable accuracy.

40. The Great Escape

Your joints can voluntarily dislocate and relocate without injury. You can escape ordinary handcuffs, ropes, and similarly restrictive bindings, provided there is enough room to maneuver. The process looks considerably more painful than it is.

41. The Human Calendar

Your body maintains a perfect awareness of elapsed time. You always know the date, approximate local time, and how long you have been awake. You can also wake yourself at a predetermined time without an alarm.

42. The Glow Worm

Your skin can emit a soft, controllable bioluminescent glow in several colors. The light is sufficient to illuminate a small room, and you can extinguish it completely. You have become the world's least convenient flashlight.

43. The Great Communicator

Your nervous system can detect the emotional state of nearby mammals through subtle chemical signals. You can recognize fear, aggression, curiosity, and affection in animals, although you cannot directly communicate with them.

44. The Human Can Opener

Your front teeth have become extraordinarily strong and sharp. You can bite through thin sheet metal, plastic, rope, and similar materials without damaging your teeth. Your jaw remains otherwise normal.

45. Nature's Umbrella

Your hair has become completely waterproof and can spread outward into a broad, rigid canopy when exposed to rain. It can keep your head and shoulders dry during ordinary rainfall. You look ridiculous, but comfortably ridiculous.

46. The Human Encyclopedia of Filth

Your immune system can identify and neutralize most common bacterial and fungal infections before symptoms develop. You can safely handle spoiled food, contaminated surfaces, and unsanitary environments without becoming ill from ordinary pathogens.

47. The Invisible Handshake

Your skin can temporarily alter its texture and coloration to match surfaces you touch. When remaining motionless against a wall, floor, or similar background, you become remarkably difficult to notice. Movement immediately disrupts the camouflage.

48. The Human Grappling Hook

Your tendons have become extraordinarily elastic. You can jump approximately three times farther than an ordinary human and safely absorb falls that would normally cause serious injury. Your legs make an unpleasant spring-like noise when you land.

49. The World's Best Babysitter

Human infants and young children instinctively find your presence calming. Crying babies often quiet when you hold them, frightened children are more willing to trust you, and ordinary childhood tantrums become easier to manage.

50. The Human Metal Detector

Your tongue can sense nearby conductive metals through a peculiar electrical sensation. You can detect concealed metallic objects within approximately two meters and roughly distinguish their size. Gold tastes like disappointment.

51. The Regifting Organ

Your body can temporarily grow a replacement for a missing minor organ or gland, provided its original function is understood by your biology. Removed tonsils, damaged glands, and similar structures gradually regenerate over several days.

52. The Human Weather Station

Changes in atmospheric pressure produce distinct sensations in your sinuses. You can predict approaching storms, major temperature changes, and significant shifts in weather several hours before they become obvious.

53. The Perfect Pitch

Your auditory system can identify exact musical frequencies without reference. You can recognize altered recordings, detect subtle changes in machinery by sound, and determine whether two apparently identical noises differ.

54. The Human Filter

Your kidneys and liver have become extraordinarily efficient. You can safely drink moderately contaminated water that would make ordinary humans ill, although

highly toxic chemicals and extreme radiation remain dangerous.

55. The Human Thermostat

Your body can maintain a comfortable internal temperature across an unusually wide range of environmental conditions. Ordinary desert heat and freezing weather cause you little discomfort, although extreme conditions can still injure you.

56. The Living Ruler

Your eyes can estimate distances, dimensions, and angles with extraordinary accuracy. You can reliably judge whether an object will fit through an opening, estimate the height of a building, or measure a room without tools.

57. The Human Printer

Your fingernails grow in thin, detachable sheets that can be peeled away without pain. By concentrating on a pattern, you can produce small embossed symbols or simple images on these sheets. They're surprisingly useful for making identification tags.

58. The Borrowed Face

Your facial muscles and soft tissues can gradually reshape themselves to resemble another human whose appearance you know well. The transformation takes approximately ten minutes and cannot substantially change your height or body type. Your voice remains unchanged.

59. The Human Root Cellar

Your stomach contains a separate biological storage pouch capable of preserving small quantities of food for several weeks without spoilage. You can retrieve the contents voluntarily. This is extremely useful and absolutely revolting.

60. The Human Periscope

Your neck can extend up to one additional meter without injury. You can peer over walls, around obstacles, and through elevated windows. Your neck returns to its normal length whenever you relax.

61. The Walking Campfire

Your skin produces a steady, harmless warmth that can be increased slightly through concentration. You can keep nearby companions warm, dry damp clothing, and prevent small containers of water from freezing. You cannot generate enough heat to ignite materials.

62. The Human Polygraph

Your body can recognize when your own memories are being altered or manipulated. You immediately notice contradictions introduced by drugs, hypnosis, or similar mental interference, although you may not know which memories are genuine.

63. The Universal Translator, Almost

Your tongue and ears have developed an instinctive understanding of basic human vocal patterns. After listening to an unfamiliar spoken language for several minutes, you can communicate simple concepts such as hunger, danger, directions, and trade without knowing its vocabulary.

64. The Human Velcro

Your skin can produce microscopic hooks that adhere to cloth, rope, and other fibrous materials. You can grip fabric securely without using your hands, climb suitable surfaces, and prevent objects from slipping from your grasp.

65. The Human Lighthouse

Your eyes can emit narrow beams of visible light, bright enough to illuminate objects several meters away. You can adjust their intensity and direction

independently. Looking directly into a mirror is a regrettable experience.

66. The Great Listener

Your brain has developed an extraordinary ability to remember conversations. You can recall not only what someone said, but their precise tone, pauses, and emotional mannerisms. You are exceptionally difficult to misquote.

67. The Human Fire Extinguisher

Your lungs can produce a dense, non-toxic gas that displaces oxygen in a small area. You can extinguish small fires by exhaling directly onto them. The gas dissipates quickly and cannot be produced in sufficient quantities to suffocate a person.

68. The Human Lie of Omission

Your body produces no involuntary physical indicators of stress. Your pulse remains steady, your hands never tremble, and you do not sweat from nervousness. Conventional physiological lie detection is almost entirely ineffective against you.

69. The Living Map

Your brain automatically constructs a detailed mental map of places you physically explore. You can retrace complicated routes, remember intersections, and navigate familiar buildings in darkness without becoming lost.

70. The Human Fishing Rod

Your tongue can extend several meters and retract with considerable precision. It is strong enough to retrieve small objects, manipulate light switches, or catch insects. Speaking while your tongue is extended is understandably difficult.

71. The Human Smoke Detector

Your respiratory system can detect combustion products at extraordinarily low concentrations. You can identify nearby fires, distinguish burning materials by smell, and recognize when a room has recently contained smoke.

72. The Human Archive

Your brain can voluntarily preserve a single sensory experience in perfect detail. You can revisit the sights, sounds, smells, and physical sensations of that moment whenever you wish. You may replace the preserved memory with a new one at any time.

73. The Human Welding Torch

Your saliva contains a chemical that rapidly hardens when exposed to air. You can use it to seal small leaks, repair cracks, and temporarily bond lightweight materials. The substance is harmless inside your mouth and dissolves after several days.

74. The Human Plumb Bob

Your body instinctively recognizes structural stress in buildings and machinery through subtle vibrations. You can identify dangerously weakened supports, unstable floors, and components approaching mechanical failure through physical contact.

75. The Human Compass Rose

Your eyes can perceive polarized light and subtle magnetic-field effects. You can navigate using the sky even under heavy cloud cover and recognize disturbances caused by large electrical installations.

76. The Human Bloodhound

Your sense of smell can detect trace chemical signatures left by human emotions. You can recognize whether a location recently contained someone experiencing intense fear, anger, or excitement, provided the trail is reasonably fresh.

77. The Living Bandage

Your skin produces a sterile, adhesive film over minor wounds. Cuts and abrasions seal almost immediately, preventing ordinary bleeding and infection. More serious injuries still require medical attention.

78. The Human Chameleon

Your hair can change color at will across the visible spectrum. You can produce elaborate patterns, imitate natural hair colors, or make your head look like a particularly unfortunate tropical bird.

79. The Human Vacuum Cleaner

Your lungs can generate unusually powerful suction without injury. You can inhale small lightweight objects from several feet away and expel them safely. You cannot inhale objects larger than your airway.

80. The Human Safe

Your body can temporarily harden the skin over a chosen area into a tough, leathery shell. The effect provides substantial protection against ordinary cuts, scrapes, and blunt impacts. The hardened skin remains flexible enough for normal movement.

81. The Human Calculator

Your brain can perform arithmetic calculations with extraordinary speed and accuracy. You can mentally handle complicated financial transactions, estimate probabilities, and detect numerical inconsistencies. This does not make you better at abstract reasoning.

82. The Human Barometer

Your body can detect extremely small changes in ambient radiation. You can distinguish ordinary background radiation from dangerous exposure and sense whether a radioactive source is approaching or receding.

83. The Human Locksmith

Your fingernails can temporarily reshape into simple rigid tools, including picks, wedges, screwdrivers, and narrow probes. They are durable enough for delicate mechanical work but cannot replace heavy equipment.

84. The Human Mirror

Your skin can become highly reflective, resembling polished silver. You can reflect light into dark spaces, signal distant observers, and confuse optical devices that rely on ordinary surface reflections. You remain otherwise completely visible.

85. The Human Icebox

Your body can safely lower the temperature of objects held against your skin. You can preserve small quantities of perishable food, cool drinks, and reduce swelling from minor injuries. You cannot freeze large objects or produce extreme cold.

86. The Human Spiderweb

Your fingertips can produce thin strands of extraordinarily strong biological fiber. The strands can be woven into rope, nets, or temporary bindings. Producing large quantities requires substantial food and time.

87. The Human Earthquake Detector

Your bones resonate faintly in response to distant seismic activity. You can detect earthquakes, underground explosions, and major structural collapses before their effects reach your location.

88. The Human Mirrorball

Your eyes can independently rotate through a full circle within their sockets. You can inspect nearly every direction without moving your head. Your eyelids still function normally, although spectators tend to wish they didn't.

89. The Human Locksmith's Nightmare

Your skin can temporarily become as slippery as lubricated glass. You can escape ordinary grapples, slide through narrow passages, and prevent adhesives from sticking to you. Clothing is unaffected.

90. The Human Orchestra Conductor

Your nervous system can perceive subtle rhythmic patterns in machinery and biological movement. You can synchronize your actions with moving mechanisms, recognize irregular heartbeats, and detect when a machine is operating outside its normal rhythm.

91. The Human Seed Bank

Your digestive system can preserve swallowed seeds without damaging them. You can store seeds internally for months and retrieve them intact. Seeds exposed to your digestive fluids often germinate unusually quickly afterward.

92. The Human Weatherproofing

Your skin produces a thin protective coating that resists ordinary acids, alkalis, and corrosive environmental contaminants. You can safely handle many substances that would irritate or burn normal skin, although industrial-strength chemicals remain dangerous.

93. The Human Searchlight

Your pupils can expand far beyond ordinary human limits. You can see clearly in extremely dim light, including moonless nights and poorly illuminated interiors. Complete darkness remains complete darkness.

94. The Human Locksmith's Friend

Your fingertips can detect residual heat patterns left on surfaces. You can determine which buttons were recently pressed, which objects were recently handled, and whether machinery was operating within the past several minutes.

95. The Human Orchestra Pit

Your chest cavity contains a harmless resonating chamber capable of amplifying your voice. You can project speech across large distances without shouting and produce remarkably convincing echoes.

96. The Human Time Capsule

Your body can temporarily suspend the decay of a small organic object held beneath your skin. A flower, biological sample, or piece of food can remain fresh for weeks. The object must fit comfortably beneath a fold of skin.

97. The Human Lightning Rod

Your nervous system can safely conduct and disperse moderate electrical currents. Ordinary electrical shocks cause little harm, and you can sometimes complete simple electrical circuits by touching exposed contacts. Extremely high voltages remain dangerous.

98. The Human Truth Serum

Your body produces a faint chemical signal that encourages nearby people to relax and speak more openly. It does not compel honesty or override conscious decisions, but ordinary strangers often find themselves unusually comfortable confiding in you.

99. The Human Miracle Worker

Your blood contains extraordinary regenerative compounds. When applied to a fresh wound, it dramatically accelerates natural healing and can prevent otherwise serious tissue damage. It cannot restore missing limbs or reverse death, and producing large quantities weakens you.

100. The Ultimate Adaptation

Your body has developed a remarkable ability to survive environmental extremes. You can endure brief exposure to conditions that would ordinarily kill a human,

including severe cold, intense heat, low oxygen, and moderate radiation. You are not invulnerable, but your body is astonishingly reluctant to give up.

Well, there you have it! One hundred reasons to be thankful for the radioactive miracle coursing through your veins. Of course, not every mutation is quite so pleasant. Turn the page, dear reader, and prepare yourself for some truly unfortunate medical developments…

THE BAD NEWS...

Now, wastelander, I must confess that not every mutation is a blessing. Sometimes the human body makes mistakes. Sometimes those mistakes are embarrassing. And sometimes those mistakes are so catastrophic that the only reasonable response is to find a doctor, a priest, and perhaps a very large bottle of whiskey.

The following mutations have been documented to produce generally undesirable results. If you recognize any of these symptoms, remain calm. Panic rarely helps, and in several documented cases has actually made things much worse.

01. The Honesty Gland

A new gland in your throat releases a pungent chemical whenever you knowingly tell a lie. The smell is unmistakable, extraordinarily unpleasant, and persists for several minutes. Technically, you can still lie. Practically, good luck.

02. Loose Lips

Your mouth occasionally repeats the last sentence you heard, in the original speaker's voice. This occurs at the GM's discretion, especially during moments when silence would be preferable. You have no conscious control over the repetition.

03. The Human Thermometer

Your body temperature fluctuates dramatically with your emotions. Anger makes you uncomfortably hot, fear makes you cold, and embarrassment can produce visible steam. The effect is harmless to you but difficult to conceal.

04. The Squeaky Wheel

One of your joints produces a loud rubber-duck squeak whenever you move it. The joint works perfectly well, but the sound makes stealth considerably more difficult. Lubricants do not help. Actual rubber ducks become strangely quiet around you.

05. The Sweet Tooth

Your saliva has become extremely sugary. Insects are attracted to you, and any food you lick becomes noticeably sweeter. You also experience an insatiable craving for sugar, and ordinary food tastes increasingly bland.

06. An Eye for an Eye

You have developed a second pair of fully functional eyes on the back of your head. You can see in both directions simultaneously. Unfortunately, your brain cannot selectively ignore either view, making crowded spaces disorienting and sleep difficult without covering both pairs.

07. Glowboy

Your skin emits a faint green glow that becomes brighter when you are frightened. The light is sufficient to read by in total darkness. Unfortunately, it makes hiding nearly impossible whenever you are scared, which is generally when you most want to hide.

08. The Bottomless Pit

Your stomach can digest almost any organic material without illness, including rotten food and many common toxins. Unfortunately, your metabolism is so aggressive

that you require approximately four times the normal amount of food to remain healthy.

09. Unfortunate Magnetism

Your body generates a weak but persistent magnetic field. Small metal objects occasionally stick to your skin, compasses become unreliable near you, and delicate electronics may malfunction after prolonged contact. You are particularly unpopular with mechanics.

10. The Human Alarm Clock

Your body has developed a flawless internal clock. You always know the precise time, even without sunlight or a working watch. Unfortunately, every morning at exactly 6:00 AM, you involuntarily scream at the top of your lungs for three seconds.

11. The Unblinking

Your eyes no longer require blinking and are immune to ordinary dust and dryness. Unfortunately, you cannot close them voluntarily. You must cover your eyes to sleep, and people find prolonged conversations with you deeply uncomfortable.

12. The Wrong Voice

Your vocal cords occasionally switch between wildly different pitches and accents without warning. This does not affect your ability to speak, but it can make impersonation, public speaking, and delicate negotiations exceptionally difficult.

13. The Human Weather Vane

Your hair grows rapidly and always points in the direction of the prevailing wind. Indoors, it points toward the nearest draft. Cutting it only works for a few hours before it regrows. Your barber has stopped returning your calls.

14. A Taste for Metal

You experience an overwhelming urge to lick exposed metal surfaces. Doing so provides a brief sense of satisfaction. Resisting the urge for long periods makes you irritable and distracted. Rust tastes particularly good, for reasons best left unexplored.

15. The Echo Chamber

Your internal organs have developed an unusual resonance. Every time you speak, a faint echo of your own voice follows approximately two seconds later. It is audible to anyone nearby and cannot be suppressed. Whispering helps, but not much.

16. The World's Worst Poker Face

Your facial muscles involuntarily exaggerate whatever emotion you are feeling. Fear produces a cartoonish expression of terror, suspicion makes you squint dramatically, and attraction causes an unmistakably stupid grin. You cannot suppress these expressions.

17. The Human Geiger Counter

Your teeth chatter in the presence of radiation, increasing in intensity as radiation levels rise. This makes you an excellent radiation detector. Unfortunately, prolonged exposure causes the chattering to become painfully loud, and you cannot stop it.

18. The Reverse Midas Touch

Your sweat is mildly corrosive to common metals. Prolonged contact can damage tools, weapons, door handles, and other equipment. Your own skin is unaffected. Gloves help, until you sweat through them.

19. The Second Opinion

A small, partially formed mouth has developed somewhere on your body. It occasionally offers unsolicited opinions about your decisions, usually in a voice resembling your own. It knows nothing you do not know, but is extraordinarily confident nonetheless.

20. The Immortal Itch

Your skin regenerates minor cuts and abrasions almost instantly. Unfortunately, the regeneration produces a persistent, maddening itch that intensifies whenever you are stressed. Scratching provides temporary relief but never eliminates the sensation.

21. Snorty McSnortface

Your nasal passages have developed a peculiar resonance. Whenever you breathe through your nose, you produce a faint musical hum. The pitch changes with your breathing. Holding your breath stops it, but ordinary stealth becomes considerably more difficult.

22. The Reverse Handshake

Your palms have developed an involuntary gripping reflex. Whenever you shake someone's hand, your fingers tighten and refuse to release for several uncomfortable seconds. The effect is harmless but makes formal introductions extraordinarily awkward.

23. The Human Popcorn Machine

Small pockets of gas occasionally form beneath your skin and burst with audible popping noises. The effect is painless but unpredictable. Loud pops are

particularly common when you are nervous or trying to remain quiet.

24. The Unfortunate Growth Spurt

Your fingernails and toenails grow at approximately twenty times the normal rate. Without regular trimming, they become long, curled, and difficult to manage. Cutting them is painless, but maintaining them is practically a full-time occupation.

25. The Internal Canteen

Your skin becomes slightly transparent whenever it rains. Veins, tendons, and superficial muscles become clearly visible until you dry off. The effect is harmless but makes you look like a walking anatomy textbook.

26. They call me the Sandwich

Your sweat produces a powerful floral fragrance that cannot be masked by ordinary soap or perfume. The scent is pleasant at first but becomes overwhelming in enclosed spaces. Tracking animals and attentive humans can follow it easily.

27. The Human Accordion

Your rib cage has become unusually flexible and occasionally expands or contracts involuntarily. This

produces loud wheezing noises and makes your torso appear to inflate like a balloon. Breathing remains normal, but fitted clothing rarely survives long.

28. The Reverse Chameleon

Your skin changes color to contrast sharply with whatever surface you are standing against. Against dark backgrounds, you become bright white; against pale backgrounds, you turn nearly black. You are exceptionally easy to spot.

29. The Human Static Generator

Your hair and skin constantly accumulate static electricity. Small sparks jump from your fingers whenever you touch metal, and your hair stands on end in dry weather. Delicate electronics are particularly vulnerable to your presence.

30. The Unfortunate Echo

Your voice occasionally emerges from your mouth several seconds after you intend to speak. You remain fully aware of what you are trying to say, but conversations become frustratingly delayed. The effect is particularly troublesome when timing matters.

31. Goo Boy

Your feet secrete a thin, slippery mucus whenever you walk barefoot. The substance is harmless but leaves a visible trail that persists for several hours. Shoes contain most of it, although they become unpleasantly damp.

32. The Wrong Temperature

Your skin feels freezing cold to anyone who touches you, regardless of your actual body temperature. This has no effect on your health but makes physical affection, medical examinations, and reassuring handshakes deeply unsettling.

33. The Human Metronome

Your heartbeat produces an audible ticking sound that can be heard in quiet rooms. The rhythm is perfectly regular and continues even while you sleep. It becomes louder during physical exertion, making stealth and relaxation difficult.

34. The World's Worst Haircut

Your hair grows in completely random directions and cannot be permanently styled. Cutting it causes the remaining hair to rearrange itself within minutes. Hats help, but your hair gradually pushes them off your head.

35. The Human Soap Bubble

Your saliva produces large quantities of harmless bubbles whenever you speak for extended periods. The bubbles float away and burst normally, but they make serious speeches and delicate negotiations extraordinarily difficult.

36. The Unfortunate Reflection

Your reflection in mirrors appears approximately five seconds behind your actual movements. The effect does not alter your body or perception, but anyone watching you in a mirror will notice the delay. You have become deeply unpopular with superstitious wastelanders.

37. The Human Mosquito Magnet

Your blood produces an irresistible chemical signal to biting insects. Mosquitoes, fleas, and similar parasites preferentially target you whenever you are nearby. Ordinary repellents are significantly less effective.

38. The Wrong Foot Forward

Your feet have gradually rotated so that your toes point backward. You can still walk normally, but your footprints appear to travel in the opposite direction. Finding properly fitting shoes is nearly impossible.

39. The Human Sneeze Cannon

Your sneezes have become extraordinarily powerful. A single sneeze can scatter loose papers, extinguish candles, or knock small objects from tables. Unfortunately, you sneeze whenever exposed to bright sunlight.

40. The Unfortunate Appetite

Your sense of taste has become inverted. Foods that ordinary humans find delicious taste revolting, while spoiled or unpleasant foods taste wonderful. You can still eat normally, but sharing meals with others becomes a miserable experience.

41. The Human Candle

Your body produces a faint smell of burning wax, and your fingertips occasionally emit tiny harmless flames when you become excited. The flames cannot be controlled and may ignite extremely flammable materials. You are forbidden from entering several reputable establishments.

42. The Wrong Shadow

Your shadow occasionally moves independently of your body, adopting poses or gestures that do not match your actions. It cannot interact with physical objects, but

it can reveal your location and cause considerable alarm among observers.

43. The Human Whistle

Your respiratory system produces a high-pitched whistle whenever you exhale forcefully. The sound is audible from a considerable distance and cannot be suppressed. Running, climbing, and other strenuous activities become remarkably conspicuous.

44. The Unfortunate Memory

Your brain has developed an extraordinary ability to remember embarrassing experiences. You can recall every humiliating moment of your life in perfect detail, including sensations and emotions. Unfortunately, these memories occasionally replay involuntarily during stressful situations.

45. The Human Glowstick

Your bodily fluids emit a bright fluorescent glow under ultraviolet light. Blood, sweat, saliva, and tears are all affected. The effect is harmless but makes forensic investigation of your activities remarkably easy.

46. The Reverse Midas Touch, Again

Your skin causes ordinary paper to become brittle and yellow after prolonged contact. Books, maps, documents, and paper currency gradually deteriorate when handled directly. Gloves prevent the effect, provided they remain intact.

47. The Human Bubble Wrap

Small, fluid-filled blisters develop across your skin whenever you become frightened. They are painless and disappear after several hours, but they burst with loud popping noises when touched. The effect is especially embarrassing during tense negotiations.

48. The Unfortunate Accent

Your speech involuntarily adopts the accent of the last person you spoke with. The effect persists until you have another conversation. You retain your vocabulary and language, but your constantly changing accent makes you sound like a terrible impersonator.

49. The Human Refrigerator

Your breath is permanently cold enough to produce visible condensation, even in warm weather. You can slightly chill small objects by breathing on them, but your mouth and throat feel perpetually cold. Hot drinks provide only temporary relief.

50. The Wrong Way Around

Your internal sense of left and right has become reversed. You instinctively reach left when intending to reach right and vice versa. You can compensate through conscious effort, but sudden instructions and reflexive actions are frequently confused.

51. The Human Confetti Cannon

Your skin periodically sheds tiny, brightly colored flakes that resemble confetti. The flakes are harmless but accumulate rapidly in clothing, bedding, and enclosed spaces. You leave a faint trail wherever you go.

52. The Unfortunate Honk

Your nose produces a loud honking noise whenever you experience surprise. The sound is involuntary and cannot be suppressed. Sudden scares, unexpected compliments, and startling revelations become particularly humiliating.

53. The Human Paperweight

Your body has become unusually dense, approximately doubling your weight without changing your appearance. You retain your normal strength and mobility, but weak

floors, fragile furniture, and small boats become serious concerns.

54. The Reverse Thermostat

Your body becomes uncomfortable whenever the surrounding temperature is perfectly pleasant. You feel cold in mild weather and overheated in comfortable rooms, but experience ordinary comfort in moderately hot or cold environments.

55. The Human Wind Chime

Your bones produce faint musical tones whenever you move. The sounds are pleasant but impossible to suppress, and become louder during rapid movement. You are effectively accompanied by a tiny invisible orchestra.

56. The Unfortunate Smile

Your facial muscles have permanently contracted into an enormous grin. You can still speak and eat normally, but your expression never changes. Delivering bad news, attending funerals, and expressing sincere concern become difficult.

57. The Human Dust Magnet

Your skin attracts airborne dust and dirt at an extraordinary rate. Even clean environments leave you visibly filthy within hours. Bathing removes the accumulated grime, but the effect resumes immediately afterward.

58. The Wrong Flavor

Everything you eat tastes faintly of gasoline. The flavor does not indicate actual contamination and has no physical effect, but it makes meals unpleasant and can conceal the taste of genuinely dangerous substances.

59. The Human Echo Locator

Your ears can detect distant sounds with remarkable sensitivity, but your brain involuntarily repeats those sounds internally for several minutes afterward. Crowded environments become overwhelming, and loud noises can leave you distracted long after they stop.

60. The Unfortunate Tail

A long, muscular tail has developed at the base of your spine. It provides modest assistance with balance and can grasp lightweight objects. Unfortunately, it moves involuntarily whenever you experience strong emotions, making deception and concealment difficult.

61. The Human Ice Cube

Your skin becomes extremely slippery whenever it gets wet. Rain, sweat, and spilled liquids make it difficult to grip objects or maintain footing. You are particularly dangerous to yourself in bathrooms.

62. The Wrong Reflection, Again

Your reflection appears to be wearing clothing different from what you are actually wearing. The reflected clothing changes unpredictably and occasionally resembles outfits you have never owned. The effect is harmless but deeply unsettling.

63. The Human Fire Alarm

Your body produces a loud, involuntary shriek whenever you smell smoke. The reaction occurs even around harmless campfires, cooking fires, and tobacco smoke. You cannot distinguish dangerous fires from ordinary ones through this reflex.

64. The Unfortunate Teeth

Your teeth have become slightly translucent and emit a faint clicking noise whenever you speak. The effect does not weaken them, but the sound makes quiet conversation difficult and gives your smile an unsettling appearance.

65. The Human Puddle

Your body periodically releases a large quantity of harmless water through your skin. The event occurs without warning and leaves you, your clothing, and nearby surfaces thoroughly soaked. You cannot control when it happens.

66. The Wrong Direction

Your body instinctively turns toward the nearest source of strong radiation whenever you are not consciously controlling your movement. You can resist the urge easily, but while distracted or asleep you may gradually orient yourself toward dangerous areas.

67. The Human Bell

Your skull produces a faint ringing noise whenever struck or tapped. The sound is audible to nearby people and can persist for several minutes. Head injuries are no more dangerous than normal, but even minor bumps become embarrassing.

68. The Unfortunate Growth

A small, harmless horn has developed on your forehead. It grows continuously and must be trimmed regularly. If neglected, it eventually becomes long enough to interfere with hats, helmets, and ordinary doorways.

69. The Human Perfume Disaster

Your body emits a different strong odor every morning. The scent may resemble flowers, gasoline, spoiled food, wet dogs, or any number of other substances. You have no control over the selection, and the smell persists throughout the day.

70. The Wrong Color

Your skin has permanently changed to a vivid, unnatural color. The exact shade is determined by the GM or player, but it is impossible to conceal without clothing or cosmetics. Ordinary people frequently assume you are dangerously radioactive.

71. The Human Doorbell

Your body produces a cheerful chiming sound whenever you enter a new enclosed space. The sound is involuntary and audible to everyone nearby. Entering buildings quietly becomes extraordinarily difficult.

72. The Unfortunate Fingertips

Your fingerprints constantly rearrange themselves into new patterns. This makes conventional fingerprint identification unreliable, but also causes your fingertips to feel slightly numb and reduces your ability to manipulate extremely delicate objects.

73. The Human Lightning Bug

Tiny sparks of harmless light occasionally appear around your body when you experience strong emotions. The sparks are visually striking but difficult to conceal. Fear, anger, and excitement make you look like a malfunctioning electrical appliance.

74. The Wrong Voice, Again

Your voice sounds approximately one octave higher whenever you speak to someone you find intimidating. The effect is involuntary and becomes more pronounced as your fear increases. Attempts to sound threatening become increasingly pathetic.

75. The Human Cactus

Small, sharp spines have developed across your forearms and shoulders. They provide modest protection against grappling and close contact, but make ordinary clothing uncomfortable and physical affection hazardous.

76. The Unfortunate Breath

Your breath contains a harmless chemical that causes nearby plants to wilt temporarily. Flowers droop, leaves curl, and delicate vegetation becomes visibly distressed when you speak directly toward it. The plants recover after several hours.

77. The Human Alarm System

Your body produces a loud clicking noise whenever you become suspicious of someone. The sound is involuntary and increases in frequency with your level of distrust. Unfortunately, it often alerts the very people you are suspicious of.

78. The Wrong Sleep Schedule

Your biological clock has become permanently inverted. You feel most alert at night and become increasingly sleepy during daylight hours. You can still function during the day, but prolonged daytime activity is exhausting.

79. The Human Velcro Disaster

Your skin produces microscopic hooks that cause clothing, bedding, and soft furnishings to cling to you. Removing attached fabrics requires considerable effort and occasionally damages them. Smooth metal and plastic surfaces are unaffected.

80. The Unfortunate Voice of Reason

A second, independent vocal organ has developed in your throat. It occasionally interrupts your speech to offer unsolicited commentary, usually criticizing your decisions. It cannot reveal information you do not know, but it is remarkably persuasive.

81. The Human Candlewick

Your hair absorbs oils and other flammable liquids at an extraordinary rate. It becomes dangerously combustible when exposed to such substances. Ordinary washing removes the absorbed material, but even small spills require immediate attention.

82. The Wrong Temperature, Again

Your hands are permanently hot enough to make prolonged contact uncomfortable. You can warm small objects by holding them, but delicate materials, cold drinks, and physical affection become difficult to manage.

83. The Human Mirror Maze

Your eyes occasionally perceive reflections where none exist. Shiny surfaces appear to contain additional rooms, doors, or people that are not actually present. The illusions are harmless but can make navigation through reflective environments confusing.

84. The Unfortunate Hunger

Your body requires a small quantity of ordinary dirt or sand each day to maintain normal digestion. Without it, you experience severe stomach discomfort. The material provides no nutritional benefit and tastes exactly as unpleasant as expected.

85. The Human Trumpet

Your nose can involuntarily produce a loud trumpet-like blast whenever you laugh. The sound is startling, difficult to suppress, and can be heard from a considerable distance. Jokes have become a genuine tactical liability.

86. The Wrong Shadow, Again

Your shadow appears to belong to a different person, often someone taller, shorter, or differently shaped than you. The effect changes unpredictably every few days. It does not affect your body, but makes observers deeply suspicious.

87. The Human Water Balloon

Your skin retains unusually large quantities of water after drinking. You become visibly bloated until the excess water is gradually released through perspiration. Drinking large amounts quickly can make movement uncomfortable.

88. The Unfortunate Whiskers

Long, sensitive whiskers have developed around your mouth and cheeks. They can detect nearby movement and airflow, but are extremely sensitive to touch. Crowded

spaces, strong winds, and ordinary grooming become irritating.

89. The Human Reverse Compass

Your body instinctively points toward the nearest large concentration of ferrous metal. You can resist the urge, but when distracted you gradually turn toward vehicles, machinery, or metal structures. You are particularly troublesome near scrap yards.

90. The Wrong Face

Your facial features gradually rearrange themselves while you sleep. The changes are subtle but noticeable, and over several weeks you may become difficult for acquaintances to recognize. Your voice, memories, and identity remain unchanged.

91. The Human Firefly Swarm

Your skin periodically releases tiny glowing particles that float around you for several minutes before fading. The particles are harmless but reveal your location in darkness and attract curious insects.

92. The Unfortunate Skeleton

Your bones have developed a faintly visible glow that can be seen through your skin in darkness. The effect is

harmless but gives you the appearance of a walking X-ray image. Concealing yourself in dark environments becomes difficult.

93. The Human Weather Disaster

Your body becomes unusually sensitive to atmospheric pressure changes. Approaching storms cause headaches, joint pain, and irritability. You can often predict bad weather, but only because you begin feeling miserable several hours beforehand.

94. The Wrong Appetite, Again

Your digestive system has developed an overwhelming preference for extremely spicy food. Ordinary meals provide little satisfaction, and you experience persistent cravings for increasingly intense flavors. Your tolerance for spice does not improve.

95. The Human Radio Interference

Your nervous system emits weak electromagnetic disturbances that interfere with nearby radio equipment. Signals become distorted within several meters of you, and sensitive receivers may produce loud static. You cannot control the effect.

96. The Unfortunate Echo of Death

Your body occasionally produces faint sounds resembling your own voice calling for help, even when you are silent. The sounds seem to originate from nearby rooms or behind walls. They are harmless but can cause considerable distress to companions.

97. The Human Gravity Problem

Your body has developed an unusual sensitivity to changes in elevation. Rapid ascents or descents cause severe dizziness and nausea, even when ordinary humans would feel nothing. Stairs are manageable, but elevators and steep mountain roads are unpleasant.

98. The Wrong Kind of Luck

You experience an extraordinary number of minor coincidences that inconvenience you without causing serious harm. Doors close just before you reach them, objects roll under furniture, and strangers frequently mistake you for someone else. The GM may introduce harmless complications whenever appropriate.

99. The Human Biological Hazard

Your body produces a faint chemical secretion that causes nearby organic materials to decay unusually quickly. Food spoils, flowers wilt, and untreated wood deteriorates after prolonged contact. The effect is slow

but persistent, and makes long-term storage of supplies difficult.

100. The Ultimate Misfortune

Your body has developed a catastrophic tendency to react unpredictably to stress. Whenever you experience extreme fear, pain, or emotional distress, one of your existing mutations temporarily becomes dramatically more pronounced. The GM determines which mutation is affected and how its effect intensifies. The result should be inconvenient, dangerous, or spectacularly embarrassing, but not automatically fatal.

Well, dear reader, I hope this list has provided some comfort. If you've discovered that your body is doing something truly horrifying, remember that you're not alone! Thousands of wastelanders are experiencing similar difficulties, and many of them have survived long enough to complain about it.

If your mutation is not listed here, please contact your nearest Radioman. We are always

eager to expand our medical knowledge, particularly when someone else is doing the suffering.